Study conducted for:

LaPorte County Indiana

Study funded by:

NIPSCO



FINDINGS REPORT

SSI PHASE II:

PRELIMINARY DUE DILIGENCE

STRATEGIC SITES INVENTORY (SSI) PROGRAM

February 20, 2023

Site ID: 18091-701

LaPorte County, IN

Study conducted by:

LEOTTA LOCATION + DESIGN

Findings Report

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Kingsbury Industrial Park

LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-701

SSI QUALIFIED SITE

Size and Location

Site: 846.7 acres
Buildable Area: 566.2 acres
E Hupp Road
Kingsbury, IN 46345

Lat. 41.5795 Long. -86.6905

Current Ownership

Martin Barr
Ed Lindborg
Brent Halfwassen

Highest and Best Use

Heavy Industrial
Light Industrial Park

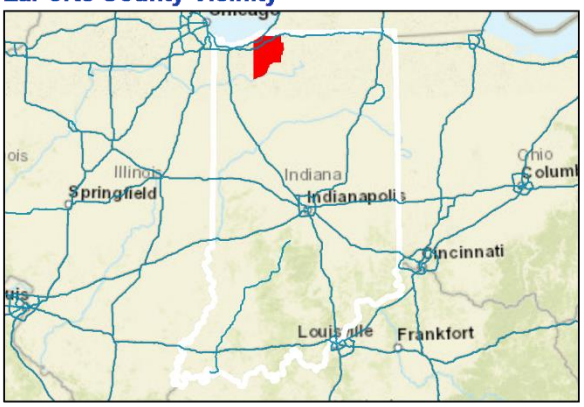
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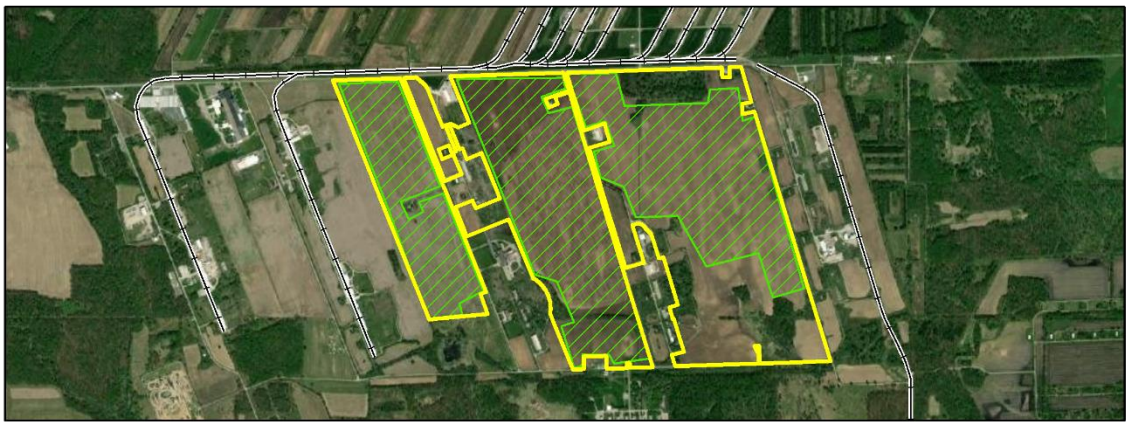
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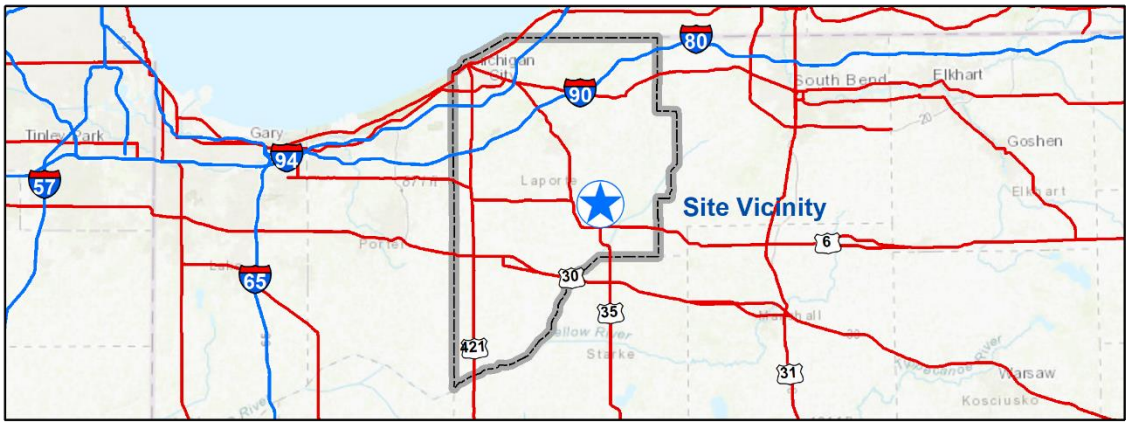
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Introduction

This report presents the findings of the Strategic Sites Inventory (SSI) Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence assessment of Site ID 18091-701 (referred to as the "Kingsbury Industrial Park"), a 846.7-acre greenfield property in the town of Kingsbury in LaPorte County, Indiana. Kingsbury is located near the City of La Porte, which serves as the county seat. The Kingsbury Industrial Park was nominated for advancement to SSI Phase II by LaPorte County officials and the Northern Indiana Public Service Company (NIPSCO). NIPSCO is the largest natural gas distribution company and one of the largest electric distribution companies in the state of Indiana, serving more than 821,000 natural gas customers and 468,000 electric customers across 30 counties. *The subject site satisfies baseline quality criteria, aligns with LaPorte County industry targets, and is deemed competitive to attract high-value business investments in support of sustainable community job growth and economic prosperity.* Report site maps are included as **Appendix A**.

SSI QUALIFIED SITE

The SSI Program is an advance site selection initiative designed to develop an inventory of strategic real estate assets to attract quality job-creating business investments. In 2019, the Indiana Economic Development Corporation (IEDC) initiated the Strategic Sites Inventory (SSI) Program in the State of Indiana with *SSI Phase I: Site Discovery* for all 92 counties with a goal to increase economic development competitiveness at the community level by identifying new, top quality raw land sites ideally suited for industrial and commercial projects. LaPorte County was included in the initial IEDC-funded project and benefitted from the identification of four potential high-value sites for mega site and heavy industrial land uses. A subsequent investment by IEDC in 2020 included expanded SSI Phase I site searches to identify light industrial and agribusiness sites, increasing LaPorte County's total of quality SSI-identified sites to forty-four. A total of 220 sites have been identified within NIPSCO's served territory.



The subject site exhibits necessary competitive characteristics for SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence nomination. Leotta Location and Design's SSI Phase II Candidate Site Index was designed to assist clients and communities with nominating the highest quality sites for advancement to SSI Phase II. According to this indexing system, a portion

of the subject site qualifies as one of LaPorte County's "top three" NIPSCO-served priority sites and ranks a top-tier priority site for heavy industrial land use within NIPSCO's statewide territory. The indexing process assigns an a-political score, or Composite Score, for SSI Phase I sites to provide a relative indication of site strength for advancement to Phase II. The stated portion of the subject site received a Composite Score of 95 out of 100. Details about the SSI Program phases are provided in **Appendix B**. The LaPorte County SSI Phase II Candidate Site Index overview is provided as **Appendix F**.

Leotta Location and Design (LL+D) has developed a systematic and effective methodology for screening potential sites for practical development as part of the SSI Phase II process. LL+D's site screening methodology is informed by fifteen-plus years of industrial and commercial site selection experience and economic development consulting in conjunction with demonstrated geospatial technology-based analysis and mapping expertise. LL+D staff and consulting partners include environmental science, civil and geotechnical engineering, landscape architecture, geospatial technologies, and economic devolvement experts who combine disciplines to identify and evaluate sites for industrial and commercial project uses.

The purpose of the SSI Phase II study is to provide a quantitative understanding of the subject site's advantages and challenges in conjunction with a rough order-of-magnitude (ROM) cost estimate to improve site functional use and mitigate development challenges. The SSI Phase II study is a desktop-based preliminary engineering and environmental due diligence exercise performed by discipline-specific experts with experience in industrial and commercial site selection and property development. Study of the subject site's physical and surrounding characteristics, assets, and impediments for development are reviewed in sufficient detail to formulate a defendable opinion on the competitive strength of the property for an economic development use.

The SSI Phase II study is intended to expose any potential "fatal flaws" that indicate significant development incumbrances or grossly compromise site competitiveness. The desktop review relies on an array of engineering, environmental, ecological, and cultural GIS data in conjunction with aerial imagery and available public records to assess current site development advantages and challenges. The SSI Phase II assessment concludes with the formulation of ROM cost estimates for improving site functional use and mitigating any potential development challenges.

LL+D's team of site selection and economic development experts provided an in-depth study of the subject site through an objective measure of physical features and surrounding characteristics and conditions across engineering, environmental, ecological, and cultural concerns. Overall site competitiveness for an economic development land use is made within the context of location requirements for permitting, construction, and operations relevant to the intended site project land use.

The SSI Phase II findings are expressed along three principal site assessment parameters:

Condition of the site's physical characteristics including assessment of engineering and environmental development advantages and challenges.

Connection to transportation assets, utility infrastructure, and major market areas.

Community support including available workforce, cultural feature impacts, and business climate for economic development.

A description of the subject site and summary of SSI Phase II findings is provided below.

Site Description

The Kingsbury Industrial Park is an undeveloped property approximately 846.7 acres in total size located just east/north of U.S. Highway 35 (US-35) and U.S. Highway 6 (US-6) along Hupp Road. It is located just outside the municipal boundary of the Town of Kingsbury in Washington Township, Indiana. The subject site is comprised of seven tax parcels, or tracts, independently owned by three (according to LaPorte County officials) or four (according to Esri GIS data and the county public geospatial portal) landowners of record. **Appendix C** provides a summary of site parcel ownership information.



Site ID 18091-701 south view from Hupp Road

Current site condition is characterized by primarily agricultural fields and small portions of forested open space. There are no structures currently observed within the site boundaries. Various commercial/industrial facilities are observed near the site, including a chemical plant, steel fabricator, plastic fabricator, foundry, and meat processing facility. Land use surrounding the site is primarily industrial, agricultural, and recreational. The cultural setting is rural in all directions. The site is bordered by Hupp Road to the north and Central Road to the south. Surrounding land use is primarily industrial, agricultural, and recreational/wildlife area.

The site is located within a stretch of land that was once a World War II era ammunition factory. The area previously housed the Kingsbury Ordnance Plant, a U.S. government installation used to manufacture military ordnance. Subsequent to the closing of the installation, various companies began operations in the area, utilizing it as an industrial park. The area is now the Fisher-Calo Chemical Superfund site. Cleanup of the area has been addressed through federal, state, and other potentially responsible parties. Cleanup operation and maintenance activities are ongoing.

Three contiguous "buildable areas" were defined within the confines of the subject site boundary intended to be most advantageous for construction. The study area's buildable areas are approximately 119.7 acres (BA-E), 222.3 acres (BA-C), and 224.2 acres (BA-W) and were defined to avoid wetlands and forested areas.

Geographic Location

Located in northwest Indiana, LaPorte County provides a rural setting near several urban areas among the high-commercial activity Indiana Toll Road (I-80/90) and Interstate 94 (I-94), with access to major markets throughout the state as well as proximity to Chicago, IL. *In direct linear measure, the site is situated approximately 23 miles southwest of South Bend, IN; 48 miles southeast of Chicago, IL; 80 miles northwest of Fort Wayne, IN; and 115 miles northwest of Indianapolis, IN.* Projects considering the Kingsbury Industrial Park will benefit from locating on the outskirts of an urban community that is strongly embedded in economic growth and prosperity amongst a primary network of connectivity, while avoiding the heavy traffic congestion and higher land costs typical of more highly populated metropolitan areas. Access to surrounding labor markets at competitive wage rates is well within reach of the subject site.



Site ID 18091-701 Site Vicinity

The subject site is located approximately 9.0 miles from the City of La Porte and just outside of Kingsbury, a town with a population of 190. La Porte serves as the county seat for LaPorte County, which has a 2021 estimated population of 112,390. The county is part of the Northwest Indiana and Michiana regions of the Chicago metropolitan area. *More than 404,392 total residential population live within a 45-minute drive of the site. Approximately 34,606 businesses employing 453,383 people are located within a 60-minute travel time*. Construction, manufacturing, and professional, scientific, & technical services account for 19.1% of businesses employing 28.9% of total workforce within a 60-minute drive time of the site. A site vicinity map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Current Ownership

The subject site is comprised of seven contiguous tax parcels, or tracts, and is reported by LaPorte County officials to have three owners. *According to LaPorte County economic development officials, the three landowners are Martin Barr, Ed Lindborg, and Brent Halfwassen. According to Esri GIS data and the LaPorte County public geospatial portal, the site has four current owners of record: Kingsbury Investments LLC, LaPorte Lake Development Inc, Barr Martin R and Marsha H, and Lindborg Edgar K and Yvonne L. The subject site is comprised of seven tracts of approximately 275.7, 252.1, 140.6, 62.6, 43.3, 37.9, and 32.9 acres according to Esri GIS data.* LaPorte County economic development officials have confirmed that their three listed landowners are actively promoting their portion of the site for sale. As of the date of this

report, no known real estate purchase option agreement is held with any person or organization with the landowners for any portion of the site. *LL+D strongly recommends that LaPorte County pursue and secure a real estate purchase option agreement with the landowners. This is critically important to reduce uncertainty regarding property availability and price*. A "Site Parcel Configuration" map is included in **Appendix A**.

Findings Summary

The findings from the SSI Phase II study are summarized below. A discussion of key site development considerations is provided within the context of overall site physical **condition**, **connection** to infrastructure, and **community** support. LL+D's site competitiveness assessment across these key site development parameters are presented below.

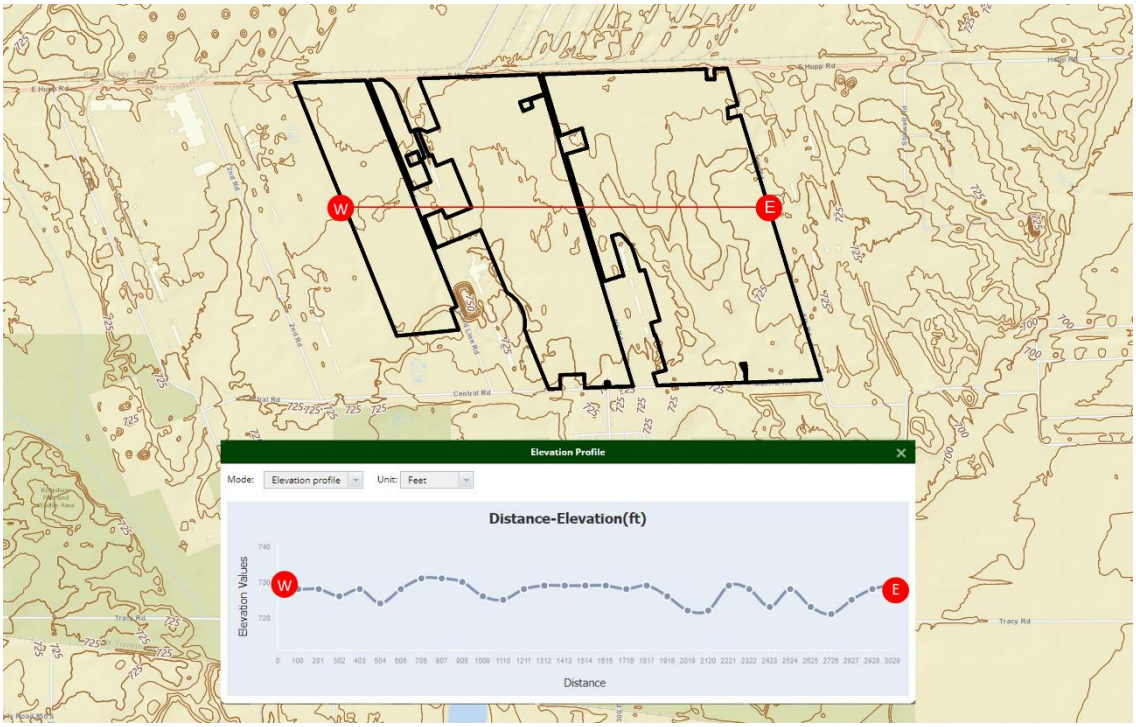
Condition

Site conditions are defined as the physical characteristics of the subject property including geometric configuration, surface features, engineering, ecological and environmental concerns, and land use compatibility. *Overall, conditions for the Kingsbury Industrial Park are favorable for development for the site's highest and best use as an economic development real estate asset*.

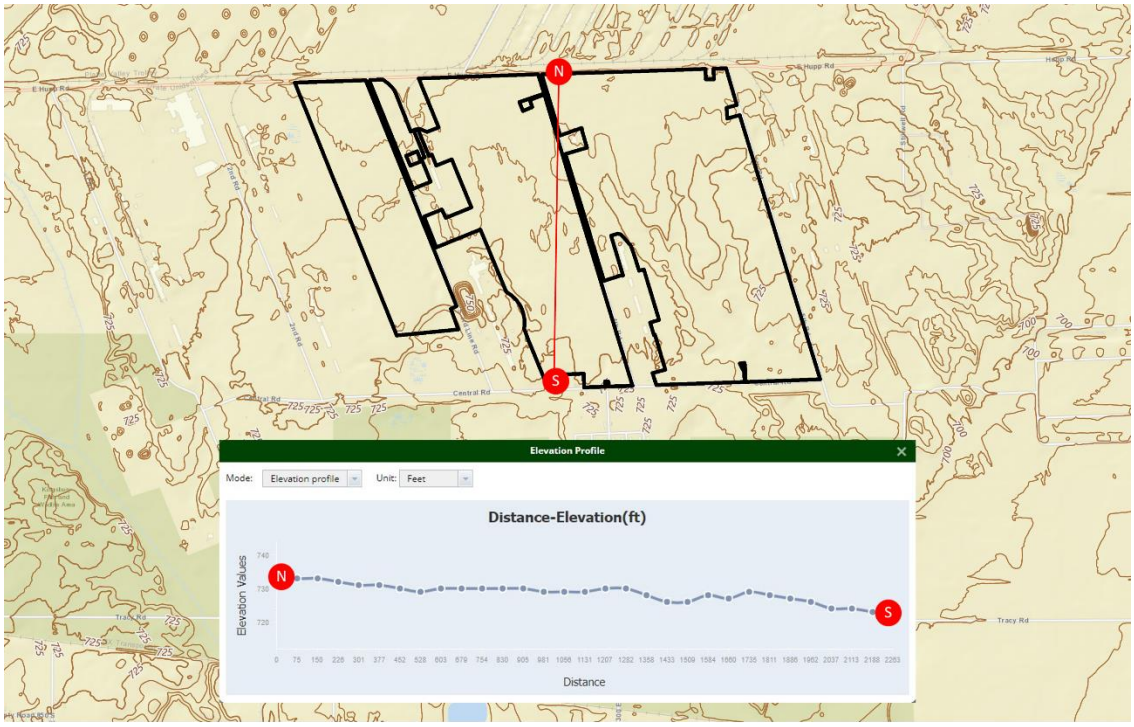
Size and Configuration of the subject site is sufficient in both acreage and configuration to support *Heavy Industrial and/or Light Industrial Park operations*. *Total site area is approximately 846.7 acres, measuring approximately 7,792 feet across an east-west axis at its widest point and approximately 5,800 feet across a north-south axis*. The site is geometrically regular in configuration with adequate land between site boundaries providing ample acreage for multiple buildable areas. Three roads running northwest to southeast divide the site into three separate buildable areas. There are several different businesses and industrial facilities located in between each buildable area along the roads. The northern site boundary is bordered by Hupp Rd, the site's primary access road.

Three separate buildable areas totaling 566.2 acres have been defined to optimize facility construction on the site by positioning operational footprints to avoid an existing road network and businesses. The buildable area occupies the majority of the site and is comprised of four tracts. Site access is supported by multiple potential ingress/egress points located on Hupp Rd along the site's northern boundary. This two-lane road connects the site to US 35, an arterial four-lane highway.

Elevation/Topography presents minor grading challenges to prepare the site for development. *Based on a review of 5-meter cell size, LiDAR-derived digital elevation models (DEM) for the full site extent, a minimum elevation of 708 feet mean sea level (MSL) and maximum elevation of 741 feet MSL is reported. The 2022 DEM indicates an average buildable area elevation of 728 feet MSL and average slope of 0.6 percent*.



18091-701 Elevation Profile West-East (USUGS 3DEP Viewer)



18091-701 Elevation Profile North-South (USGS 3DEP Viewer)

The majority of the site is generally flat and without significant sloping. The lowest elevation occurs along the southeasternmost portion of the site, just outside of the buildable area. This area of lower elevation occupies about one third of the respective parcels' total area. With the flat topography, there are not likely many cut-fill opportunities for use of onsite fill for grading/leveling. This analysis is subject to an onsite geotechnical engineering investigation to determine suitability of soil properties for construction. Additionally, any areas of naturally occurring sloping topography may provide passive locations for site buildable area drainage and stormwater retention. A LiDAR-derived DEM and 10-ft contour map is provided as **Appendix A**.

Land Cover assessment is useful for identifying site design constraints and/or potential encumbrances that may be encountered during site development such as extensive clearing and grubbing, drainage concerns, etc. The vegetative cover type is used in conjunction with soil types, elevation, and hydrography data for interpretation of environmentally sensitive conditions such as wetlands and potential habitat for Threatened and Endangered (T&E) species and other species of concern (discussed later in this report). Certain land cover features may reveal commercial value of forested areas or be desirable to incorporate into the site design. Features such as densely wooded areas may provide a desirable buffer during construction and/or during facility operations for line of sight and noise control. Another example is integrating wetland areas into site plans, thus providing an element of design aesthetics.

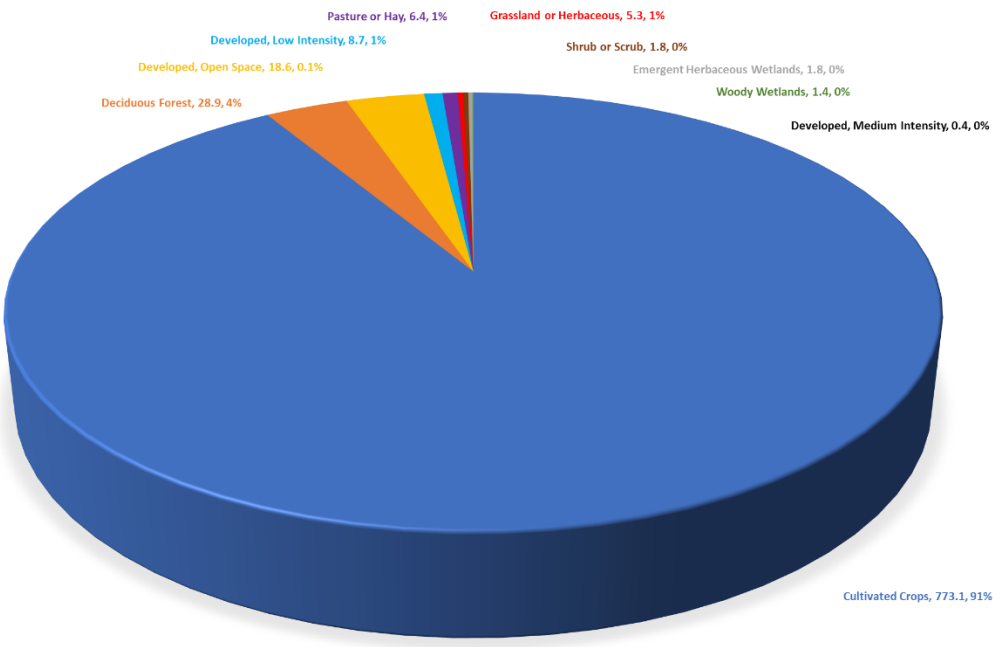
Two primary sources were used to assess land cover characteristics:

1) *Recent high-resolution color aerial imagery* (ESRI/Google Earth 2022). Recent and past aerial imagery provide useful observational data for assessing current land cover conditions, as well as any notable changes over time. However, aerial imagery alone cannot be used without additional data sources to provide a more specific delineation of land cover type. For example, densely wooded areas are readily observed from aerial imagery, however, determination of forest composition is largely indeterminate without other remotely sensed inputs (i.e., color infrared imagery) or ground-based observation.

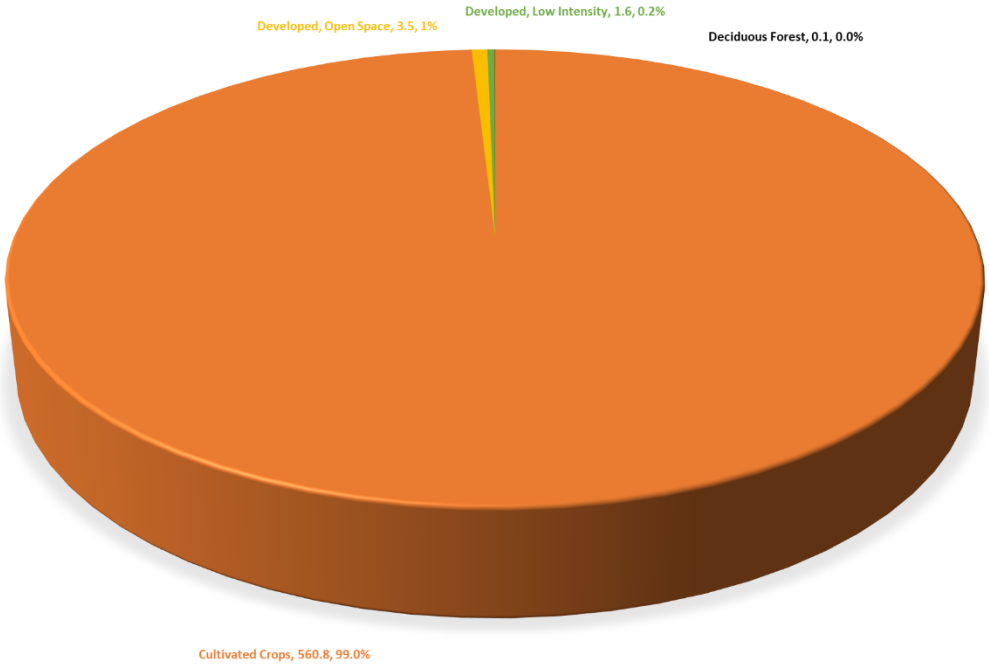
2) *The Multi-Resolution Land Characteristics Consortium (MRLC), National Land Cover Database (NLCD)*. The National Land Cover Database (NLCD) provides nationwide data on land cover and land cover change at a 30m resolution with a 16-class legend based on a modified Anderson Level II classification system. NLCD 2019 represents the latest evolution of NLCD land cover products focused on providing innovative land cover and land cover change data for the Nation. NLCD 2019 offers 8 integrated epochs of land cover for years 2001, 2004, 2006, 2008, 2011, 2013, 2016, and 2019. Developed classes in these years are directly derived from percent developed impervious surface and include a descriptor label that identifies the type of each impervious surface pixel. The NLCD Land Cover change index combines information from all years of land cover change and provides a simple and comprehensive way to visualize change from all 8 dates of land cover in a single layer.

Based on a review of the MRLC NLCD dataset, land cover for the site and buildable area consists of the following classified areas (acres, percent cover):

Land Cover – Site (acres, %)



Land Cover – Buildable Area (acres, %)



A Land cover map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Hydrography and Flood Risk were evaluated by consulting USGS National Hydrography Dataset (NHD), a geospatial database which identifies stream segments or reaches that make up the nation's surface water drainage system, and FEMA National Flood Hazard Layer (NFHL), a geospatial database that contains current effective flood hazard data. *Based on a review of NHD and NFHL data, the site and buildable area are highly favorable for site development with low flood risk and minimal recorded/observed significant hydrography features. 100% of the site is outside the FEMA-designated flood hazard area and is designated as Flood Zone X (within 0.2-percent-annual-chance flood or 500-year floodplain). The nearest flood hazard area is a north-south running ditch named Travis Ditch found approximately 1.2 miles west of the site. This feature is located outside of the buildable area and should not pose any significant challenges for future project construction. An area of lower elevation on the southeastern portion of the site may be able to provide passive locations for site buildable area drainage and stormwater retention.* A hydrography and FEMA flood hazard map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Potential Wetlands are interpolated through observation of multiple data inputs including:

1) USGS National Wetlands Inventory (NWI) – developed for non-404 jurisdictional wetland mapping, so must be understood to have limited accuracy
2) LiDAR-derived digital elevation model (DEM) – topography/elevation
3) USGS NHD – hydrography
4) NRCS SSURGO – soils data provides hydric rating
5) Color-infrared imagery (where available) – for visual indication of wet or inundated areas (consulting differing years to ensure wet areas are not the result of a period flood event)

The NWI data is consulted as the principal indicator of potential wetlands, as the mapping methodology utilizes the above-referenced inputs in addition to other data sources in conjunction with qualified scientific review and quality control of interpolated wetlands delineation and taxonomy. The NWI data also provides a delineation of wetland types, which is important in the estimation of permitting burden and potential compensatory mitigation costs. The additional data sources are consulted to ensure congruency of information suggestive of potential wetlands occurrence.

From the US EPA Wetland Regulatory Authority fact sheet, wetlands subject to Clean Water Act Section 404 are defined as “areas that are inundated or saturated by surface or ground water at a frequency and duration sufficient to support, and that under normal circumstances do support, a prevalence of vegetation typically adapted for life in saturated soil conditions. Wetlands generally include swamps, marshes, bogs, and similar areas.” There are three primary conditions required for surface areas to be considered wetlands: 1) at least periodically, the land supports predominantly hydrophytes, 2) the substrate is predominantly undrained hydric soil, and 3) the substrate is saturated with water or covered by shallow water at some time during the growing season of each year. As determined by the U.S. Army Corps of Engineers, the federal agency responsible for enforcing federal laws protecting wetlands, an area must exhibit all three of the above-referenced conditions to be considered a wetland.

The following GIS-based information was consulted for the desktop wetlands assessment:

- **Hydrophytic Vegetation**: Recent and historical aerial imagery and NWI data.
- **Wetland Hydrology**: LiDAR-derived DEM, USGS topo maps, and high-resolution aerial imagery.

- **Hydric Soils**: NRCS Web Soil Survey and SSURGO data.

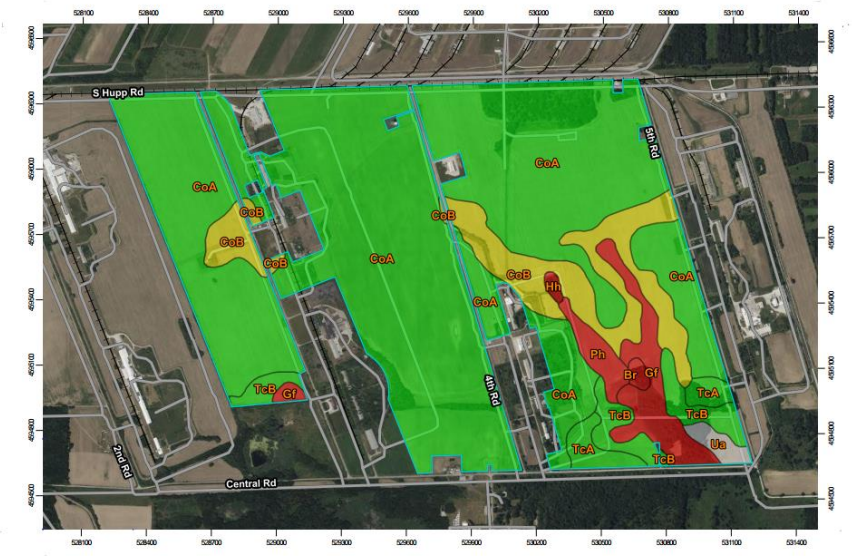
There are approximately 7.17 acres of potential wetlands reported on the subject site. The wetland areas are located along the southeastern boundary of the site and are classified as "freshwater emergent" wetlands. Emergent wetlands are a transitional area between permanently wet and dry environments. It is a place where the land "emerges" from the water to join the forest and the plants that grow there. *According to the SSURGO Hydrologic Soil Group map, 6.3% of the total site has soils estimated to have hydric components. These soils are almost completely outside of the proposed buildable area and are located on the southeastern portion of the site near the potential wetland areas. While no potential wetlands are reported within the buildable area, wetland permitting and mitigation may be required on the subject site. This appears to pose minimal development impediments to the site*. NWI potential wetlands map is provided as **Appendix A**.



Aerial Imagery of Onsite Potential Wetlands (Google Earth 2022)

Soils conditions are assessed to identify potential advantages and/or challenges that could have an impact on site design, construction, and overall use of the site. Soil types are evaluated with respect to drainage and engineering performance for excavations, road construction, and building foundation support. Additionally, hydric soil ratings are used in conjunction with wetlands data to increase confidence in potential wetlands interpretation (reported in previous section).

According to the United States Department of Agriculture (USDA), Natural Resource Conservation Service (NRCS) Soil Survey Geographic Database (SSURGO) accessed via the NRCS Web Soil Survey, *76.5% (647.9 acres) of the subject site soils are classified as "Coupee silt loam, 0 to 2 percent slopes" with a drainage class of "Well drained." An additional 17.2% (144.9 acres) of the site has a rating of "well drained" with various types of Coupee silt loam, Tracy sand loam, and loamy Udorthents soils. Somewhat poorly drained to very poorly drained soil types including Bourbon sandy loam, Gilford fine sandy loam, Pinhook loam, and Histosols*



and Aquolls make up the remaining 6.3% (43.9 acres) of the site. These soils are assigned to SSURGO hydrologic soil groups and have very slow to high infiltration rates with high to low runoff potential; the majority of the site consists of soils with moderate infiltration rates and runoff potential.

Soil suitability properties for small commercial building construction across 82.4% (697.4 acres) of the subject site are indicated as "Not limited" for shallow (2 feet deep) reinforced concrete spread footings. "Not limited" indicates that the soil has features that are very favorable for the specified use. An additional 10.4% (88.2 acres) is indicated as "Somewhat limited", meaning the soil contains features that are moderately favorable for the specified use. The limitations can be overcome or minimized with special planning, design, or installation. Fair performance and moderate maintenance can be expected. The remaining 6.4% (53.9 acres) of the subject site is indicated as "Very limited" for shallow reinforced concrete footings, while 0.9% (7.2 acres) is "Null or Not Rated". "Very limited" indicates that the soil has one or more features that are unfavorable for the specified use. The limitations generally cannot be overcome without major soil reclamation, special design, or expensive installation procedures. Poor performance and high maintenance can be expected.

The majority of the buildable area has soils that are very favorable for an industrial project land use. Good performance and very low maintenance can be expected. The onsite areas that contain soils with poor drainage class, hydric soils group, and limited small commercial building construction rating are primarily located outside of the buildable area on the easternmost portion of the site. A SSURGO soils map is provided in **Appendix A**. The USDA, NRCR SSURGO soils reports for drainage class, small commercial buildings, and hydric rating are provided in **Appendix G**.

Sinkholes are common geological phenomenon occurring throughout the United States. They are only one of many kinds of karst landforms, which include caves, disappearing streams, springs, and underground drainage systems. Karst is a generic term which refers to the characteristic terrain produced by erosional processes associated with the chemical weathering and dissolution of limestone or dolomite.

The Sinkhole Areas and Sinking-Stream Basins Map developed by the Indiana Geological Survey shows the locations of sinkhole areas (SHA) and sinking-stream basins (SSB) in southern Indiana. Some sinkholes may exist outside the delineated areas, and some sinkholes may exist within the areas designated as sinking-stream basins, but such areas are not shown in this map. *The subject site lies entirely outside of the SHA and SSB areas, and thus should not be at risk of sinkholes.* The reliability of reported sinkhole occurrences is unknown. Potential site susceptibility to sinkholes must be determined through more thorough professional geological and geotechnical engineering investigation.

Zoning and Land Use is administered and governed by LaPorte County and the 2016 LaPorte County Joint Zoning Ordinance. *According to SSI Pre-Project Questionnaire, the site is currently zoned "M2" Heavy Industrial. The 2014 Washington Township Zoning Map also shows the site as being zoned "M2" Heavy Industrial.* A County Zoning Map is provided in **Appendix D.**

The apparent current land use of the subject site is derived from the LaPorte County Joint Zoning Ordinance, recent aerial imagery, and Google Street View. *Recent aerial imagery shows current land use to be agricultural/vacant land as evidenced by minimal forested areas and lack of commercial structures. Adjacent to the site are various industrial buildings. The aerial imagery-derived land use observations for*

the site agree with the 2016 LaPorte County Joint Zoning Ordinance's Agricultural designation. It also matches with the NLC Database – Cultivated Crops (91%) land cover classifications.

Current land use immediately surrounding the subject site to the north consists mainly of agricultural lands, warehouses, railroad tracks, and the Kingsbury Fish and Wildlife Area. The wildlife area also extends to the northeast, east, and southwest. Additional warehousing structures exist south of the site. Directly east and west of the site is industrial land use, part of the wider expanse of the Kingsbury Industrial Park. Agricultural lands are also observed to the east, north, and south. Current land use is observed from recent aerial imagery (ESRI 2023/Google Earth 2021).

There is little to no indication of other land uses within the site boundary over the last ninety-three years based on a review of historical aerial imagery dating to 1939 (provided by EDR Radius report). Fifteen epochs from 1939 to 2020 were reviewed to determine the sequential occupancy of the subject site. Since 1939, the subject site has been consistently used for agriculture. Between 1939 and 1951, new roads were placed near the site, crossing slightly into the site boundary toward the south-central portion and northwest portion. At this time, several structures were also constructed in various areas surrounding the site boundary. Between 1973 and 1998, some apparently wet areas in the center of the site and along a north-south drainage ditch on the site's western half had light to moderate shrub and tree growth, which was removed by 2005. While the reason for the clearing of the trees is not determinate, no detrimental issue is suspected. Historical aerial imagery is included in the EDR Radius Report provided as **Appendix H**.

Current site land use is ideal to support future development of the site for Industrial land uses. Surrounding tract land use is compatible with the intended site use immediately around the buildable area. The land use is indicated from the 2014 Washington Township Zoning Map to be Industrial to the immediate north, south, east, and west, with primarily Agricultural land surrounding the immediate vicinity. The current and future land use designations for surrounding properties will likely not present perceived use compatibility issues with both prospective companies and the public.

Relevant excerpts from the 2016 LaPorte County Joint Zoning Ordinance prescribing zoning and land use polices, standards, and statutory requirements for land development are included in **Appendix D**. The 2016 LaPorte County Joint Zoning Ordinance full documents should be consulted for detailed requirements pertaining to land use and zoning district designations.

Threatened and Endangered Species are defined under the federal Endangered Species Act (ESA) of 1973. The ESA provides a program for the conservation of threatened and endangered (T&E) plants and animals and the habitats in which they are found. The lead federal agencies for implementing ESA are the U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service (USFWS) and the U.S. National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA) Fisheries Service. The USFWS maintains a worldwide list of endangered species. Species include birds, insects, fish, reptiles, mammals, crustaceans, flowers, grasses, and trees.

The ESA defines an *endangered species* as "any species which is in danger of extinction throughout all or a significant portion of its range." Endangered species are automatically protected by prohibitions of several types of "take," including harming, harassing, collecting, or killing, under Section 9 of the ESA. There are some limited exceptions to these rules listed in Section 10 of the ESA. The ESA defines a *threatened species* as "any species which is likely to become an endangered species within the foreseeable

future throughout all or a significant portion of its range." Threatened species receive protections through separate regulations issued under Section 4(d) of the ESA.

LL+D staff consulted the USFWS Information for Planning and Consultation (IPaC) online tool (https://ipac.ecosphere.fws.gov/) to assess potential project effect on listed species (*a plant or animal that receives federal protections under the Endangered Species Act. Species can be protected as endangered or threatened*) and other USFWS trust resources (*includes migratory birds, species listed as threatened and endangered under the Endangered Species Act, interjurisdictional fishes, marine mammals, wetlands, and lands managed by USFWS, such as national wildlife refuges*). The IPaC tool is a project planning tool that streamlines the USFWS environmental review process.

An IPaC Resource List was generated for the subject site. The Resource List is a report that automatically generates a list of species and other resources such as critical habitat (collectively referred to as trust resources) under USFWS jurisdiction that are known or expected to be on or near the project area referenced below. The list may also include trust resources that occur outside of the project area, but that could potentially be directly or indirectly affected by activities in the project area. However, determining the likelihood and extent of effects a project may have on trust resources typically requires gathering additional site-specific (e.g., vegetation/species surveys) and project-specific (e.g., magnitude and timing of proposed activities) information.

The IPaC trust resources report lists critical habitats and species of concern known or suspected to be found in habitats within regional ecology. The IPaC trust resources report found that the following species may potentially be affected by activities in this location:

- **Mammals**:
  - Indiana Bat (*Myotis sodalist*) – Endangered
  - Northern Long-eared Bat (*Myotis septentrionalis*) – Threatened
- **Insects**:
  - Monarch Butterfly (*Danaus plexippus*) – Candidate
- **Critical Habitats**:
  - There are no critical habitats at this location.

The IPaC report also identifies the Migratory Birds Resource List that identifies certain birds protected under the Migratory Bird Treaty Act of 1918 and the Bald and Golden Eagle Protection Act of 1940. Birds listed in the report are birds of particular concern either because they occur on the USFWS Birds of Conservation Concern (BCC) list or warrant special attention within the subject site location. The report does not include a list of every bird found within the site location, nor a guarantee that every bird on this list will be found within the site. The migratory bird list is derived from data provided by the Avian Knowledge Network (AKN). The AKN data is based on a growing collection of survey, banding, and citizen science datasets and is queried and altered to return a list of those birds reported as occurring in the 10km grid cell(s) that intersect the specified site study area location and have been identified as warranting special attention because they are a BCC species or an eagle (Eagle Protection Act requirements may apply) in that area.

The IPaC Migratory Birds Resource List (MBRL) provides a "Probability of Presence" summary indicating the best understanding of when birds of concern are most likely to be present in the site area. *While there is no immediate known impact to site development, the MBRL should be further reviewed within the context of environmental permitting requirements by a qualified environmental/ecological consultant, as temporal migratory bird presence may affect the timing of certain construction-related activities on the subject site*. The IPaC trust resources report is provided in **Appendix E**.

Legacy Environmental Concerns consist of historical activities and events both on the subject site and on nearby tracts where harmful contaminants were released into soil, surface water, and groundwater. If not properly remediated under state and federal regulatory requirements by qualified environmental consultants/contractors, historical contamination liabilities may be inherited through chain of title even if the contamination originated offsite, particularly with migration through groundwater transport. The historical environmental event implication for site development depends on many factors including the type, extent, concentration, complexity, physical setting and surface/subsurface conditions, and time since the event, which may or may not pose a risk to prospective investors on site development.

A cursory review of the subject site and surrounding properties was conducted to identify any potential legacy environmental concerns. Informational resources consulted for this review include:

- EDR Radius Report;
- Recent and historical aerial imagery review;
- US Environmental Protection Agency's (EPA) Enforcement and Compliance History Online (ECHO) database (EDR Radius Report limits ECHO database search to the target property); and
- Information provided through interviews with local political officials, economic development representatives, and landowners (where available)

The EDR Radius Report searches environmental databases for permitted facilities, events, and other potential concerns occurring on the subject site and up to 1.0 mile of the site boundary. EDR use statement: "*A search of available environmental records was conducted by Environmental Data Resources, Inc (EDR). The report was designed to assist parties seeking to meet the search requirements of EPA's Standards and Practices for All Appropriate Inquiries (40 CFR Part 312), the ASTM Standard Practice for Environmental Site Assessments (E 1527-13), the ASTM Standard Practice for Environmental Site Assessments for Forestland or Rural Property (E 2247-16), the ASTM Standard Practice for Limited Environmental Due Diligence: Transaction Screen Process (E 1528-14) or custom requirements developed for the evaluation of environmental risk associated with a parcel of real estate*".

Based on the results of the EDR Radius Report and a cursory review of historical aerial imagery, seven environmental legacy concerns were identified near the subject site. Six facilities appearing in multiple databases were identified within 0.25 miles of the subject site in the EDR Mapped Sites Summary:

- ***FISHER-CALO***
  - *Databases: NPL (National Priority List database); SEMS (Superfund Enterprise Management System); Federal Engineering Controls Registry; Federal Institutional Controls Registry; ROD (Record of Decision); CONSENT (Major Legal Settlements for Superfund Sites); PRP (Potentially Responsible Parties)*

- *Distance: within 200 feet*
- *Elevation: Same*
- *Map ID* 1 *(overview map below)*

- ***KINGSBURY ORDINANCE PLANT***
  - *Databases: UXO (Unexploded Ordinance Site Locations); FUDS (Formerly Used Defense Sites)*
  - *Distance: within 0.2 miles*
  - *Elevation: lower (725' MSL)*
  - *Map ID* 2

- ***DWYER INSTRUMENTS INC***
  - *Database: RCRA-VSQG (Resource Conservation and Recovery Act - Very Small Quantity Generator)*
  - *Distance: within 0.2 miles*
  - *Elevation: higher (736' MSL)*
  - *Map ID* 3

- ***TELEDYNE CASTING SERVICE***
  - *Databases: RCRA NonGen/NLR (Resource Conservation and Recovery Act – Non-Generator); FINDS (Facility Index System/Facility Registry Systems)*
  - *Distance: within 0.2 miles*
  - *Elevation: higher (730' MSL)*
  - *Map ID* 4

- ***CASTEEL SERVICE INC***
  - *Database: UST (Underground Storage Tank)*
  - *Distance: within 0.2 miles*
  - *Elevation: higher (730' MSL)*
  - *Map ID* 5

- ***BETHLEHAM STEEL***
  - *Database: PFAS ECHO (Per- and Polyfluorinated Substances – Enforcement and Compliance History Online)*
  - *Distance: within 0.25 miles*
  - *Elevation: higher (735' MSL)*
  - *Map ID* 6

- ***DYNO NOBEL, INC***
    - *Databases: CORRACTS (Resource Conservation and Recovery Act – Corrective Action Authority); RCRA-TSDT (Resource Conservation and Recovery Act – Treatment Storage and Disposal); RCRA NonGen/NLR (Resource Conservation and Recovery Act – Non-Generator)*
    - *Distance: within 1 mile*
    - *Elevation: lower (725'MSL)*
    - *Map ID* 7

Just west of the subject site's boundary, in the area surrounding One Line Rd and Two Line Rd, is the Fisher-Calo Chemical (FCC) site (Map ID #1). Fisher-Calo is a former industrial chemical processing and distribution facility. The facility is in an area that previously housed the Kingsbury Ordnance Plant, a U.S. government installation used to manufacture military ordnance. Fisher-Calo Chemical and Solvents Corporation operated a solvents reclamation and waste storage facility on the property from late 1972 through mid-1978. FCC was primarily engaged in the reclamation of spent solvents. As part of their operations, FCC produced a still-bottom waste which they accumulated in 55-gallon drums. Sodium hypochlorite was produced, and sulfur dioxide, chloride, ammonia, and various solvents were packaged at the site. Cyanide, acids, and metal plating wastes were also accepted from other industries, stored in metal drums, and stockpiled on the site or dumped on the ground. *During the time of operation, Fisher-Calo was the subject of numerous violations and orders to abate contamination and correct poor management practices.*



In 1974, a fire occurred in an area containing FCC waste paint pigment and other waste drums which resulted in the destruction of about 1,000 drums of chemical waste. In 1978, a more significant fire broke out at the site's solvent reclamation facility destroying several bulk storage tanks, trucks, and approximately 20,000 drums of chemical wastes and solvents. The 1978 fire required the evacuation of over 10,000 area residents.

The U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (USEPA) listed the site on the National Priorities List (NPL) in 1983. EPA then funded and undertook the Remedial Investigation (RI)/Feasibility Study (FS) for the Site and determined that, as a result of the historical operations at the Site, the groundwater and soil had become contaminated with volatile organic compounds (VOCs), semi-volatile organic compounds (SVOCs), polychlorinated biphenyls (PCBs) and asbestos. In addition, while doing work, it became clear to EPA that some of the environmental contamination needed to be addressed immediately.

The RI determined that four groundwater contaminant plumes exist within the Site. Two plumes are present at the One Line Road property, and the Two Line Road and Space Leasing Area properties each have one plume. In the ROD, the primary contaminants of concern (COCs) in groundwater were noted to be chlorinated volatile organic compounds (CVOCs). The hydrogeology at the site consists of an upper and a lower aquifer. The four groundwater contaminant plumes are located in the shallow portion of the upper aquifer. The general groundwater flow direction of the upper aquifer is south/southwesterly at the One Line Road and Two Line Road properties, influenced by Travis Ditch to the west.

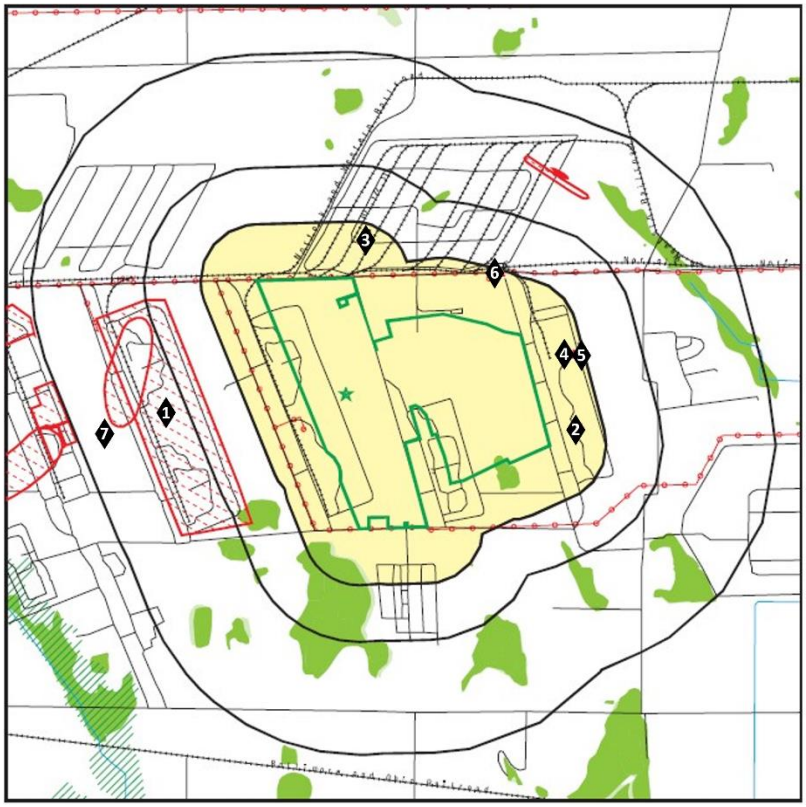
The site has been addressed through federal, state, and potentially responsible parties (PRPs) actions and has achieved several cleanup milestones including preliminary assessment/site inspection, remedial investigation feasibility study, records of decisions, and remedial design/remedial action. Construction Completion has also taken place, indicating that all physical construction required for the cleanup of the entire site has been completed (even though final cleanup levels have not been achieved). For example, a groundwater treatment system has been constructed though it may need to operate for several years for all contaminants to be removed from the groundwater. The site's long-term remedy included the excavation and off-site disposal of buried drums, excavation and off-site disposal of PCB-contaminated soils, soil vapor extraction, and groundwater pumping and treatment. Construction of the remedy took place between 1994 and 1998. *Cleanup operation and maintenance activities are ongoing.*

The site has not been removed from the National Priorities List, meaning that it is still not fully protective of human health and the environment. The next milestone to be achieved is sitewide readiness for anticipated reuse and redevelopment. The estimated date for completion is listed as September to November 2024 by the EPA. Partial NPL Deletion is estimated for August to October 2025. The site is currently being evaluated under a national optimization and green remediation pilot study. The EPA completed its most recent five-year review in 2020 with the following results: The report did not determine the protectiveness of the remedy at the site pending further information, which is expected upon completion of a vapor intrusion study by the fall of 2021. The vapor intrusion study consists of monitoring the groundwater, exterior soil gas, sub-slab soil gas and indoor air of buildings. Once the additional vapor intrusion study is complete, EPA will be able to move forward to determine what institutional controls are necessary minimize the potential for human exposure to contamination and/or protect the integrity of the remedy.

There has been a significant amount of effort put into remediating the Fisher-Calo Superfund site. The biggest concern for the Kingsbury Industrial Park is the potential for contaminant migration from the FCC superfund site and uncertainty involving unexpected costs, delay, and liabilities that could result in challenges with obtaining the capital investment needed to develop the site. A review of the most recent Five-Year Review Report from the EPA shows that all five of the soil areas designated as "Source Areas" of pollution were successfully remediated to appropriate levels. No information for water contamination on the subject site has been provided, but groundwater contamination still exists within the FCC superfund site. If the contamination has migrated to the subject site's groundwater, another option is in place. A municipal water supply is available in a significant portion of the Kingsbury Industrial Park through the Kingsbury Utility Corporation to provide clean water to businesses. The extent of potential contamination

resulting from the cited facilities may not be fully understood without conduction of more extensive environmental site investigations on the subject site by a qualified consultant.

Relevant excerpts from the Fifth Five-Year Review Report for the Fisher-Calo Superfund Site have been attached as **Appendix O**. This includes site background information and response actions summary items.



EDR Radius Report Mapped Sites Overview Map

A facility referred to as the Kingsbury Ordnance Plant (Map ID #2) is located adjacent to the site's eastern boundary on S Fifth Line Rd. The former Kingsbury Ordnance Plant (KOP) began explosives manufacturing and loading operations in 1941. From 1946 through 1951, KOP was operated by the U.S. Ordnance Department and was used for the storage and demilitarization of explosives. Starting in about 1949, KOP was used for loading and production of ammunition used in the Korean War. Military munitions were produced or demilitarized at this location and therefore may present an explosive hazard. Current land use at the KOP includes about 7,100 acres which are part of the Kingsbury Fish and Wildlife Area (KFWA), military reserve training purposes (about 996 acres), commercial/industrial development (about 5,000 acres), and the remainder in agricultural use and residential housing. A map detailing the unexploded ordinance site locations is included in **Appendix O**.

The unexploded ordinance area appears to be greater than a half mile to the east of the subject site and does not appear to be a threat to onsite development.

A facility referred to as Dwyer Instruments Inc. (Map ID #3) is located just north of the site across Hupp Road. This facility appears in the Resource Conservation and Recovery Act – Very Small Quantity Generator (RCRA-VSQG) database. A very small quantity generator (VSQG) is any generator that generates the following amounts of hazardous waste in a calendar month: Less than 100 kilograms (220 pounds) of hazardous waste and less than 1 kilogram (2.2 pounds or 1 quart) of acute hazardous waste. VSQGs are recommended to manage hazardous waste in containers or tanks that are in good condition to prevent spills and releases to the environment that endangers human health.

The following hazardous waste codes are reported for the facility: Tetrachloroethylene, trichlorethylene, methylene chloride, 1,1,1,-trichloroethane, carbon tetrachloride and chlorinated fluorocarbons. The existence of a VSQG adjacent to the subject site does not pose an environmental concern. All generators of hazardous waste are required to comply with management standards determined and outlined by the U.S. EPA's Resource Conservation and Recovery Act (RCRA). The generator regulations ensure that hazardous waste is appropriately identified and handled safely to protect human health and the environment. *A review of the aerial imagery indicates that there is no treatment or disposal of hazardous waste on-site. There is also no mention of any violations of EPA standards in the EDR Radius report.*

Two facilities referred to as Teledyne Casting Service and Casteel Service Inc. (Map ID #4) are located adjacent to the site's eastern boundary on S Fifth Line Rd. The first facility, Teledyne Casting Service, appears in the Resource Conservation and Recovery Act – NonGen/NLR database. Non-Generators do not presently generate hazardous waste. Therefore, the facility does not appear to pose any threat to the subject site. The second facility, Casteel Service Inc, appears in the Underground Storage Tank database. It is listed as permanently out of service. *This facility should not pose an environmental concern for the subject site since there is no record of petroleum-related contamination. However, the extent of potential contamination resulting from the cited facilities may not be fully understood without conduction of more extensive environmental site investigations by a qualified consultant.*

A facility referred to as Bethlehem Steel (Map ID #6) adjacent to the subject site's northeast boundary. The industry type is listed as metal coating and fabricated metal product manufacturing. There are no violations reported and the facility's status is listed as "Inactive". The facility is listed in the PFAS ECHO database, a list of facilities using Per- and Polyfluorinated Substances (PFAS). The per-and polyfluoroalkyl substances (PFAS) are a group of chemicals used to make fluoropolymer coatings and products that resist heat, oil, stains, grease, and water. *This facility should not pose an environmental concern for the subject site since it is inactive and there is no record of any violations.*

The last listed facility is referred to as Dyno Nobel Inc (Map ID #7), and is located approximately 1 mile to the west of the subject site, near the Fisher-Calo Superfund site. The facility is listed in the CORRACTS database, a list of handlers with RCRA Corrective Authority Activity. It is also listed in the RCRA-TSDF database which shows sites that generate, transport, store, treat and/or dispose of hazardous waste. The site has a NAICS description of "Explosives Manufacturing" and a waste description of "Reactive Waste". Many corrective actions and violations were issued throughout the mid 1990's. *The facility's proximity to the Fisher-Calo Superfund raises the question of whether the two are associated. This is indeterminate at the time of this report and needs further investigation.* Full facility information is provided in EDR Radius Report is provided as **Appendix H**.

As the EDR Radius report limits environmental database searches to the subject site and within 1.0 mile of the subject site, the EPA ECHO database was consulted for potential significant environmental concerns within 2.0 miles of the site including active permitted facilities operating under the EPA Clean Water Act, Title V of the Clean Air Act, or the Resource Conservation and Recovery Act (RCRA) for control of solid waste. In limited instances, new air permit applications can be subject to more stringent requirements based on nearby existing permitted facilities' total air emission pollutant volumes and concentrations.

ECHO search results reported one facility within a 2-mile radius of the subject site that is currently in violation of environmental regulations. The facility is called Precoat Metals Inc. and is located on Hupp Rd about half a mile east of the subject site. Precoat Metals has been out of compliance status since 8/16/2021 and has 10 quarters with no compliance and 1 quarter with a significant violation. The pollutant causing the contamination is Chromium. It cannot be determined if harmful contaminants have been released into the soil and/or groundwater on the subject site. Many factors should be considered including the contamination type, extent, concentration, complexity, physical setting and surface/subsurface conditions, and time since the event. LL+D recommends that a Phase I Environmental Site Assessment (ESA) be conducted to ensure that no contamination issues are present on site. The ECHO site search results are provided in **Appendix H**.

The NPDES permit program addresses water pollution by regulating point sources that discharge pollutants to waters of the United States. Created in 1972 by the Clean Water Act, the NPDES permit program is authorized to state governments by EPA to perform many permitting, administrative, and enforcement aspects of the program. Pollutants commonly discharged by small WWTPs at SNC violation levels include oxygen-demanding substances (e.g., biochemical oxygen demand (BOD), chemical oxygen demand (COD)), total suspended solids (TSS), pathogens (i.e., fecal coliform/E. coli), nutrients, and total residual chlorine. Small systems often have difficulty keeping trained operators and obtaining adequate funding for operations, maintenance, and system upgrades needed to achieve and maintain compliance.

The ECHO site search results are provided in **Appendix H**.

As with any desktop research exercise, actual potential environmental concerns may not be fully recognized or understood without conducting an on-site field investigation. The industry standard for real estate environmental review is the Phase I Environmental Site Assessment (ESA). Governed by the ASTM E1527: *Standard Practice for Environmental Site Assessments: Phase I Environmental Site Assessment Process.* The Phase I ESA is designed to investigate property prior to ownership transfer or improvements for use to identify and document any existing or potential contamination that must be addressed or give cause for liability. The Phase I ESA methodology includes more detailed research and review of environmental databases, historical aerial imagery, title research, and on-site field observations of the subject site and immediately surrounding properties.

Connection

Site connectivity includes access to key transportation assets and utility infrastructure sufficient for the use intensity of the subject site. Access to available workforce is also measured within the context of the intended economic development project use (e.g., heavy industrial, light industrial, commercial/freight logistics, etc.). *The Kingsbury Industrial Park is well connected to transportation and utility assets with close proximity to local utilities access (potable water, sewer, electric, natural gas, and telco/broadband). In conjunction with strong community support and adequate workforce availability, the site is well positioned for competitive response to heavy industrial and light industrial project opportunities*.

Transportation Assets are in place to serve the logistical needs of commercial/industrial business operations in the area. *Substantial transportation connections to the site include close proximity to multilane divided U.S. highway access and direct rail-line access.*

Access to the site is currently available via Hupp Road, a two-lane industrial road that runs along the site's northern boundary. Multiple points of ingress/egress can be constructed along Hupp Road. From the site, truck traffic must travel approximately 1.9 miles west on Hupp Road to access U.S. Highway 35 (US-35), a minor arterial highway. Traffic must then travel 14.4 miles north to reach Interstate 94 (I-94). If accessing Indiana Toll Road, Interstate 80/90 (I-80/90), traffic must first turn onto Indiana State Road 39 (SR-39) after traveling north on US-35 for 8.7 miles, then continue on SR-39 for 2.5 miles before passing through the Indiana Toll Road La Porte Toll Plaza. Both U.S. Highway 6 (US-6) and U.S. Highway 30 (US-30) are also accessible from the site for east-west travel. US-6 is accessible within 2 miles of the Kingsbury Industrial Park and eventually leads to I-80/90, I-94, and I-65 to the west and I-69 to the east; US-30 eventually gains access to I-65 to the west and I-69 to the east. While all roadways leading to interstate access appear to be in good condition and suitable for truck traffic, the 11-plus-mile distance from the site is considered a challenge for certain industry types. Site access map is included in **Appendix A**.

Truck Routes accessible by the site include US-35 for immediate north-south travel and US-6 for immediate east-west travel. Alternate routes for east-west travel include I-80/90, I-94, and US-30. I-80/90, a toll road, can be reached in approximately 11.2 miles via US-35 and SR-39. I-94 access is located 14.4 miles northwest of the site. Both I-80/90 and I-94 can be taken west for 68.4 and 71.2 miles, respectively, to reach Chicago and multiple other truck routes including I-65, I-57, I-55, I-88, US-41, US-52, and US-34. US-35 can be taken south to the heart of Indianapolis, approximately 138 miles from the site. Both US-Highway route 6 and 30 can also be taken to get to Indianapolis, each trending generally east-west and connecting to U.S. Highway 31 (US-31) to the east, which can then be taken southward to the city. East-west travel routes, including I-80/90, US-6 and US-30, can be taken to eventually connect to I-65 within 40 miles and I-69 within 100 miles for additional north-south travel. Having many available truck routes is considered a strength for the site. However, being 11-plus-miles from interstate access and potentially having to navigate through the City of La Porte via US-35 for interstate access is considered a challenge. A transportation vicinity map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Railroads run extensively throughout the area surrounding the site, including a CSXT mainline and a short-line rail operated by JBC. The CSXT Class I railroad tracks are located east of the site and generally run north to south. This mainline connects to the JBC short-line and curves to the west, running parallel with the site's northern boundary across Hupp Road. *There are several rail spurs that cross over Hupp Road heading south into the broader expanse of the Kingsbury Industrial Park. With over a mile of straight track and no visible encumbrances between the buildable area and tracks, the subject site should be in an ideal position for pulling off one or more rail spurs.* A transportation vicinity map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Airport access is beneficial for both corporate executive and other business-related representatives travel to a facility during construction and when operational. Cargo airport access provides opportunity for transportation of process input materials and product distribution.

South Bend International Airport (SBN) is a freight and commercial airport located within 29.4 miles (~45-minute drive time). It is the closest airport to the subject site. SBN has three asphalt runways measuring 4,300 by 75 feet, 8,414 by 150 feet, and 7,100 by 150 feet. Within Indiana, the airport is second in passenger enplanements (417,929) after Indianapolis International (4,375,317). In 2019 the airport handled 47,756 aircraft operations, averaging 130 per day. The airport's proximity to the site is considered a significant strength for the Barr Industrial Property.

Gary/Chicago International Airport (GYY) is located 44.0 miles west of the subject site (~60-minute drive). The airport has an 8,859-ft runway, which is the 2nd longest in the region and can handle planes up to and including a 777, one of the largest planes in the world. It is a full-service airport with commercial charter, corporate and cargo flights that support the general aviation needs of LaPorte County.

The Chicago Midway International Airport (MDW) is located 74.3 miles west of the site (~1 hour and 30-minute drive). Midway is a major commercial airport, one of the busiest airports in the nation, and the second-busiest airport both in the Chicago metropolitan area and the state of Illinois, serving 7,669,456 passengers in 2021. The Chicago Midway International Airport covers just over one square mile and has five runways.

The Indianapolis International Airport (IND) is approximately 143.0 miles south (~3 hour drive) of the subject site. IND is home to the second largest FedEx Express hub in the world and was ranked as the sixth busiest U.S. airport in terms of air cargo throughput in 2020.

Seaport access is provided by Burns Harbor located within approximately 32.3 miles (~45-minute drive) northwest of the site. It is located on Lake Michigan in the heart of the steel industry. Burns Harbor is a port focused on steel, agriculture, and manufacturing located on Lake Michigan in the heart of the steel industry.

Utility Infrastructure is optimal for the subject site. Kingsbury Utility Corporation (KUC) provides water service and sewer lines and NIPSCO provides natural gas and electric service. The site has access to telecom infrastructure provided by Verizon, Comcast, CSINET, AT&T. Water, sewer, natural gas, electric, and telecom lines are all located adjacent to the site. Water and sewer lines run throughout the site via existing supply networks. Electric distribution lines and transmission lines are adjacent to the site along with a substation at the site's northeast corner. Gas distribution mains exist at various locations throughout the site. Utility service points of access all currently exist at the site. Site utility information obtained from the "Local Site Survey Questionnaire" is provided as **Appendix J**. An energy infrastructure and utility access point map is provided as **Appendix A**. County-provided utility infrastructure overview maps are included as **Appendix L.**

Potable Water is provided by an existing service network operated by KUC. Main lines throughout the water supply system run generally southeast to northwest as well as west to east

and vary between 8", 10", and 12" in diameter. There are two water towers nearby—one is located adjacent to the site near the central northern boundary and the other is approximately 0.85 miles from the site's southwest corner. KUC currently operates three potable wells with approximately 1.5 million gallons per day (MGD) of capacity. Current and proposed water service flow/capacities should be verified on a project-by-project basis with KUC. Information provided by LaPorte County in the "Local Site Survey Questionnaire" can be found in **Appendix J**. A utility infrastructure overview map can be found in **Appendix A.** County-provided utility infrastructure overview maps are included as **Appendix L.**

Sewer/Wastewater is available to the subject site with an existing service network operated by KUC. Generally, there is a gravity sewer of 12" in diameter located near any site parcel. Sewer main lines primarily run diagonally southeast to northwest, with some lines trending generally west to east. The Wastewater Treatment Plant (WWTP) has approximately 2 MGD of capacity at normal wastewater strengths. Current and proposed capacities should be verified on a project-by-project basis with KUC. Information provided by LaPorte County in the "Local Site Survey Questionnaire" can be found in **Appendix J**. A utility infrastructure overview map can be found in **Appendix A.** County-provided utility infrastructure overview maps are included as **Appendix L.**

Natural Gas is available via an existing network of distribution lines. 2-inch steel distribution main lines with up to 60 psig run generally along 1st, 2nd, 3rd, and 4th Road. A main line runs from 4th Rd east through the site's eastern buildable area (BA-E). There is also a 2-inch plastic distribution main with up to 60 psig adjacent to the site's eastern boundary and an 8-inch steel distribution main west of the site further along Hupp Road. Natural gas service is provided by NIPSCO. High volume natural gas delivery capability exists and should be able to support large natural gas consumption projects. Information provided by LaPorte County in the "Local Site Survey Questionnaire" can be found in **Appendix J**. A utility infrastructure overview map can be found in **Appendix A.** County-provided utility infrastructure overview maps are included as **Appendix L.**

Electric power is provided by NIPSCO with 12.5kV 3-Phase electric distribution lines adjacent to the site along 1st, 2nd, 3rd, 4th, and 5th Road and along the railroad tracks east of the site. Adjacent 69kV transmission lines are also located at the site's northern boundary along Hupp Road and along 3rd Road. There are 345kV transmission lines within 1.25 miles north of Hupp Road as well. The nearest substations identified by NIPSCO are the Deer Run Electric Substation located at the site's northeast corner, the Kingsbury Electric Substation located within 2.2 miles northwest of the site, and the Stillwell Electric Substation located approximately 3.0 miles northeast of the site. Total available MW capacity for the substations is unknown at the time of this report. Information provided by LaPorte County in the "Local Site Survey Questionnaire" can be found in **Appendix J**. A utility infrastructure overview map can be found in **Appendix A.** County-provided utility infrastructure overview maps are included as **Appendix L.**

Telco/Broadband service is provided by Verizon, Comcast, CSINET, AT&T. Newly placed lines are adjacent to the site according to county officials. Specifics regarding telecommunication lines such as the exact location and date of installation are unknown and should be verified with county

officials. According to attendees of the SSI Local Sites Review workshop in February 2022, fiber optic investments have been made and easement access to install enterprise level connectivity with two different options are available. Information provided by LaPorte County in the "Local Site Survey Questionnaire" can be found in **Appendix J**. A utility infrastructure overview map can be found in **Appendix A.**

Major Market Areas are accessible within a two-hour drive of the subject site. By vehicular travel, the site is situated 69.7 miles from Chicago to the west and 157 miles from Indianapolis to the southeast with 2021 total populations of 2,696,555 and 882,039, respectively. Travel distances to major markets and seaports are provided below. A major market vicinity map is provided as **Appendix A.**

Time and Distance to Major Markets

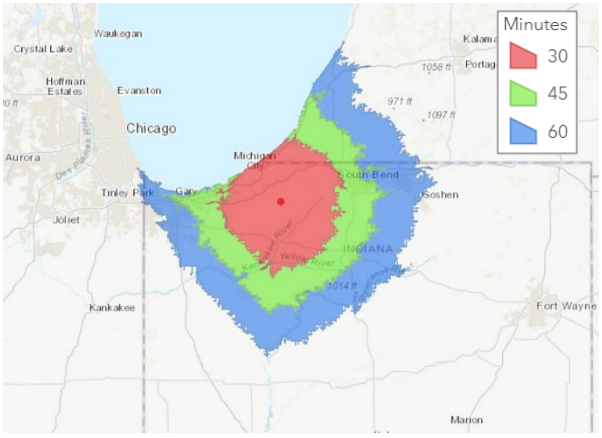
Major Markets	Travel Time	Miles
Chicago, IL	1:22	69.7
Fort Wayne, IN	1:53	98
Indianapolis, IN	2:38	157
Milwaukee, WI	2:50	160
Toledo, OH	3:03	190
Detroit, MI	3:37	235
Cincinnati, OH	4:01	253
Louisville, KY	4:12	265
Columbus, OH	4:27	261
Cleveland, OH	4:35	291
Lexington, KY	5:15	334
St. Louis, MO	5:17	341
Nashville	6:45	439

Time and Distance to Ports

Ports of Indiana	Travel Time	Miles
Burns Harbor	0:47	32.2
Jeffersonville	4:09	262
Mount Vernon	5:29	342

Community

Community aspects conducive to site competitiveness include both measurable and intangible factors that can either strengthen or undermine a site's inherent competitive advantages. While workforce availability and cultural features are commonly accounted for, business and political climate are often neglected, yet serve as an important indicator for both community and governmental desired to welcome new business investment. The LaPorte County community and political leadership are strong proponents of business growth and new job creation, creating a



business climate highly conducive to project investment support through efficient permitting, workforce training, and competitive tax structures. LaPorte County is committed to supporting long-term industrial and commercial business operations in its communities.

Description of the Economy

LaPorte County is located in Indiana, a state that boasts a business-friendly environment, solid infrastructure, and substantial creation of manufacturing jobs. The county falls within the Northwest region of Indiana and has a population of 112,390 (US Census Bureau). La Porte, the county seat, has a population of 22,383 (US Census Bureau). The largest city in the county is Michigan City with a 2021 population of 32,033. The county's strong manufacturing history and commitment to industry helps to drive local drive economic growth. It is also influenced by the smaller metropolitan regional center of South Bend. LaPorte County is part of the Chicago Metropolitan Statistical Area (MSA), an area that spans 19 counties throughout the Midwestern United States and had a 2020 census population of 9,618,502. Further information about LaPorte County population and economic trends can be found in the 2008 Countywide Land Development Plan, provided as **Appendix M.**

Demographics

LaPorte County had a 2010 population density of approximately 186 persons per square mile, compared to the state population density of 181 ppsm, and is the fifteenth most populated county in the State of Indiana. The population, considering race alone or in combination with one or more other races, is roughly 86.0% White, 13.2% Black or African American, 0.7% Native American, 0.9% Asian, and 2.6% some other race. Approximately 6.6% of the population are Hispanic or Latino. The county's median age is 40.3.

Employment and the Economy and Income

LaPorte County, IN is home to a highly engaged and skilled local workforce with a total resident labor force of approximately 50,768 people. Unemployment (6.1%) is higher than the state average (4.8%). Manufacturing; Educational Services, Health Care & Social Assistance; and Retail Trade make up the largest industries in the county, employing 21.8%, 21.3%, and 11.8% of workers, respectively. The Manufacturing sector employs 10,395 people; Educational Services, Health Care & Social Assistance employs 10,145 people; and Retail Trade employs 5,611 people. The highest paying industries in LaPorte County, by median earnings, are Utilities, Transportation and Warehousing, and Manufacturing, with 2020 median annual earnings of $73,750, $50,365, and $49,626, respectively. According to county officials, the county average wage is $44,189. Median household income is $53,658, which is less than the median annual income of $62,843 across the United States.

Population/Workforce *within a 60-minute drive time from the site include a total population of more than 963,754 and 34,606-plus businesses employing over 453,383 people according to Esri 2022 demographic data. Construction, manufacturing, and professional, scientific, & technical services account for 19.1% of businesses employing 28.9% of total workforce within the 60-minute drive time of the site*. A 30, 45, and 60-minute drive-time query of employment numbers for construction and manufacturing jobs (by NAICS Code) was performed for the subject site. The following employment numbers were reported:

30, 45, 60-minute Drive-time Employment Count*

Business Type by NAICS Codes	Employees		
	30-min	45-min	60-min
Construction	3,260	12,733	27,362
Manufacturing	10,312	39,036	88,718
Professional, Scientific & Tech Services	1,596	8,816	18,978
Totals	**15,168**	**60,585**	**135,058**

**Source: Copyright 2023 Infogroup, Inc. All rights reserved. Esri Total Residential Population forecasts for 2023.*

LaPorte County target industries include electric vehicle components and manufacturers and other heavy industry. With access to a total workforce of over 467,702 which includes 135,058-plus employed in construction, manufacturing, and professional, scientific, and technical services sectors, adequate workforce availability should meet medium to large-scale project labor demands of county industry targets. Population and business summary reports are provided in **Appendix I**.

Cultural Features within three miles of the subject site that may pose community risk or public opposition to industrial development are limited and generally do not affect site permitting, construction, or facility operation. Fire and police protection and emergency medical services are within relatively close proximity of the subject site, however, these facilities do not pose cross-transportation risks for site construction or facility operation. A cultural features map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Schools do not exist immediately proximate to the site or along principal site access routes. There are two elementary schools within three miles of the subject site. Site buildable area and site ingress/egress road access does not overlap with local school access routes. As such, the site poses no significant operational proximity or transportation risks to schools.

Churches surrounding the site largely exist in Union Township. There are nine churches within three miles of the subject site buildable area. All churches are sufficiently removed from the operational footprint of the site. As such, the site poses no significant operational proximity or transportation risks to churches.

Cemeteries do not exist immediately proximate to the site or along principal site access routes. Two cemeteries are within three miles of the site buildable area, though this poses no risk to site permitting or operation.

Group Care Centers including nursing homes, assisted living centers, special education schools, crisis units, and hospice facilities do not exist immediately proximate to the site or along principal site access routes. No assisted living facilities are located within 3 miles of the subject site.

Other Cultural Centers including libraries, museums and art galleries, movie theaters and performing arts centers, zoos and aquariums, arboreta and botanical gardens, and planetariums do not exist immediately proximate to the site or along principal site access routes. The former

Kingsbury Ordnance Factory is adjacent to the subject site, however, this should not pose any threat to site development. Kingsford Heights library is located within three miles of the site buildable area, though this poses no risk to site permitting or operation.

Parks and Protected Lands exist in close proximity to the site. The Kingsbury Fish and Wildlife Area spans in several directions surrounding the Kingsbury Industrial Park. This area is sufficiently removed from the operational footprint of the site (e.g., buildable area). While the area's access road is located along the site ingress/egress road, this poses no risk to site permitting or operation. A protected lands map is provided in **Appendix A**.

Correctional Facilities including federal, state, and local prisons and detention centers do not exist immediately proximate to the site or along principal site access routes. The LaPorte County Jail and the Laporte County Community Corrections Center are both located in the City of La Porte about 10 miles from the site.

Fire Protection/EMS is provided by the Kingsbury Volunteer Fire Department located within a 2.8-mile driving distance of the site. The response route is roughly 5 minutes, with trucks taking Pleasant St to US-35 before turning onto Hupp Rd. The Kingsford Heights Fire Department is another option located 4.8 miles and a 7-minute drive from the site with the response route running from Drummond Rd to Meadowbrook Blvd to US-35 and Hupp Rd. There are three additional fire departments located within a 10-minute drive of the site. These include the Pleasant Twp Fire Department, the Scipio Twp Volunteer Fire Department Station 2, and the Noble Township Fire Department. Fire and EMS response time and capacity should be locally verified.

Law Enforcement is provided by the Kingsford Heights Town Marshal located within 5.2 miles of the site boundary/buildable area. The response route is Park Rd or Grayton Rd to Meadowbrook Blvd, then US-35 to Hupp Rd and is approximately a 9-minute drive time from the site. The La Porte Police Department and La Porte County Sheriff's Office are also located 8.5 miles and a 12-minute drive, and 9 miles and a 13-minute drive, respectively, from site access. Law enforcement response time and capacity should be locally verified.

Hospital/Emergency Care is provided by two different hospitals within 10 miles of the subject site: Northwest Health and Franciscan Beacon Hospital. Northwest Health is located 9.0 miles from the site (~13-minute drive time) via Tyler St, Lincoln Hwy, and US-35 to Hupp Rd. It is an acute care hospital with 74 total staffed beds. Franciscan Beacon Hospital is located 9.1 miles (~14-minute drive time) from the site via J St, 5th St, Plummer St, and US-35 to Hupp Rd. The hospital is an acute care hospital and 24/7 ER with a 10-bed emergency department and 8 inpatient beds.

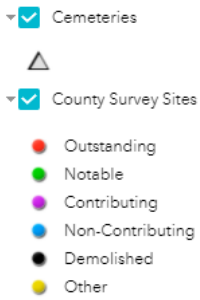
Historical Preservation records include locations of cultural or archaeological significance, some of which are formally designated as state and/or federally protected historical resources under State Historic Preservation Offices (SHPO) and/or National Register of Historic Places registrations. Historical resources, if located on the subject site, may alter, impede, or preclude development if potential for disturbance or

encroachment exists. Historical resources located near the subject site may warrant mitigating site planning and design elements such as line-of-site buffering between facilities and a historically significant structure. The Indiana Department of Natural Resources (IDNR) houses the Division of Historic Preservation and Archaeology (DHPA), which promotes the conservation of Indiana's cultural resources. The DHPA facilitates state and federal preservation programs and is the staff of the State Historic Preservation Office. The DHPA's Archaeology Team administers programs for protecting and preserving Indiana's prehistoric and historic archaeological sites, is the central repository of archaeological records and reports, and houses the state's official computerized database of archaeological site information.

Several cultural resource GIS datasets from the IDNR were consulted for potential location of culturally or historically significant resources on or near the subject site. These datasets are collected and contained within the State Historic Architectural and Archaeological Research Database (SHAARD), which allows users to search cultural resource information on known historic and archaeological resources throughout the State of Indiana. SHAARD includes data from the Indiana Historic Sites and Structures Inventory county survey (IHSSI), the Indiana Cemetery and Burial Ground Registry, historic bridges and canals, historic theaters, and properties listed in the National Register of Historic Places and the Indiana Register of Historic Sites and Structures. The data contained in SHAARD was collected from previously conducted cultural resource inventories, National Register nominations, and cultural resource management projects. SHAARD and associated resource maps are ongoing initiatives and are updated daily, so the absence of data does not necessarily indicate the absence of resources. A more formal archaeological survey may be necessary prior to site development.



SHAARD Map Search



A desktop data review was conducted regarding available records for potential cultural resources present on the subject property. *The SHAARD database identified no archaeological sites and no historic structures on the subject site. Ten historic structures were identified within a 2-mile radius of the subject site's centroid, including a group of assembly buildings, timekeepers building, office, bunker, well house, melt loading building, tetryl pelleting building, inert material warehouse, ammunition storage warehouses, and explosive storage igloos. The reported structures (Survey Numbers 091-344-82001, 091-344-82010, 004-344-27001, 091-610-82014, 091-344-82013, 091-344-82015, 091-344-82009, 091-316-82016, 091-344-82001, and 091-344-82002, respectively) are shown on the corresponding SHAARD web application map. Of the structures shown, four are listed as "notable" while the remaining six are listed as "contributing".* A "notable" rating means that the property did not quite merit an "outstanding" rating but still is above average in its importance. Further research may reveal that the property is eligible for National Register listing. A "contributing" rating means that the property met the basic inventory criterion of being pre-1970, but that it is not important enough to stand on its own as individually "outstanding" or "notable". Such resources are important to the destiny

or continuity of an area's historic fabric. The specified historic structures do not likely present significant impediments to the development of the subject site.

As the site's location is within an existing industrial park, the structures listed are unlikely to inhibit the development of the property. Several additional historically significant resources are located outside the 2-mile buffer surrounding the subject site's centroid but are not likely to impact site development potential. The SHAARD/IHSSI Reports for both structures are provided as **Appendix K**, and the Historic Resource search map is provided as **Appendix A**.

As with any desktop research exercise, actual potential historic preservation concerns may not be fully recognized or understood without conducting an on-site field investigation. The industry standard for real estate environmental review is the Phase I Cultural Resources Survey. The primary objective of a Phase I archaeological survey is to identify and record all cultural resources within a project area. Cultural resources can include prehistoric Native American habitation sites, historic farmstead sites, standing structures, or other man-made features such as earthworks, old roadbeds, or cemeteries. The Phase I survey process typically begins with Phase IA Archaeological Reconnaissance to conduct historical research, environmental context review, and field inspection. When an archaeological site is encountered, a full written report must be submitted following guidance provided in the Current Guidebook for Indiana Historic Sites and Structures Inventory—Archaeological Sites and the Indiana Cultural Resources Manual.

Indiana Code 14-21-1 provides protection for archaeological sites and historic burial sites regardless of their location on state or private lands. All archaeological sites with artifacts dating before December 31, 1870 are protected under this act. Human burial sites are afforded protection under IC 14-21-1, IC 14-21-2, IC 23-14 (Indiana General Cemetery Act). The State of Indiana implements specialized reviews that provide protection to historic properties on state-owned or leased land or to historic properties that are listed in the National Register of Historic Places or the Indiana Register of Historic Sites and Structures and that will be altered, demolished, or removed using state funds. These review processes are established in Sections 14, 16, and 18 of Indiana Code 14-21-1. In addition, projects that will disturb the ground within 100 feet of a cemetery or burial ground for the purpose of excavating or covering the ground or erecting, altering, or repairing any structure are reviewed in Sections 26-26.5. In order to increase the confidence in understanding any potential historical preservation concerns for the subject site, it is recommended that a Phase I archaeological survey be conducted by a qualified cultural resource management/archaeological consulting professional and that archaeology state laws listed in Title 14, Article 21 of the Indiana Code are thoroughly understood. Relevant sections of the Indiana Code are provided as **Appendix K.** Information regarding Indiana Archaeology Law, complete with links to the full Indiana Code and Indiana Administrative Code, is also provided as **Appendix K.**

Education and Technical Training Assets are well positioned to serve professional and technical workforce needs of LaPorte County target industries, while colleges and universities provide valuable recruiting opportunities to local businesses.

The Indiana Department of Workforce Development (DWD) offers a variety of services to statewide job seekers looking to enter the workforce, return to the workforce, or locate education and training opportunities. These include Hoosier Talent Network, INDemand Jobs, Indiana Career Explorer, Indiana Career Connect, Cyberseek Indiana, and Indiana Career Ready. The DWD offers several services including job search help, hiring events, training grants, specialized training and more: https://www.in.gov/dwd/.

Indiana's WorkOne Career Centers are the heart of the workforce development system, providing assistance in understanding jobs in demand today, helping workers determine their interests and abilities, offering access to training opportunities, and providing information needed to succeed in today's economy. WorkOne's Job Opportunities and Business Services (JOBS) Program assists employers in locating and developing a skilled team by determining eligibility, recruiting employees, formulating WorkKeys job profiles, and providing skills assessments to identify gaps and training needs. WorkOne's WIN Career Readiness is a fundamental workplace skills training system available to Indiana residents, employers and training providers. Both the DWD's Work Opportunity Tax Credit (WOTC) and Federal Bonding Program benefits employers by offering incentives for hiring jobseekers who may traditionally have difficulty finding employment.

Next Level Jobs provides free training for Indiana workers and reimbursements for Indiana employers for training employees in high-demand fields. Next Level Jobs assists job seekers by providing Indiana residents with free training in high-growth job fields and the opportunity for them to earn a high-value certificate in one of Indiana's in-demand job fields, tuition free. Next Level Jobs assists employers with reimbursements for training their employees through the Employer Training Grant, which will reimburse an employer for up to $5,000 per trained employee who is trained, hired, and retained for six months, granting up to $50,000 per employer.

The Center of Workforce Innovations is a non-profit corporation dedicated to addressing workforce development needs. The Center acts on behalf of the Local Workforce Investment Board which serves several counties in Northwest Indiana, providing education resources and workforce training assistance.

The University of Notre Dame du Lac (Notre Dame), a private Catholic research university outside the City of South Bend, is located within a 50-minute drive time of the site. Notre Dame has been recognized as one of the top universities in the United States and has been at the forefront in research and scholarship and had a total undergraduate enrollment of 8,874 in the fall of 2020. Valparaiso University is a private university located within a 30-minute drive time of the subject site and had an undergraduate enrollment of 2,723 in the fall of 2020.

Ivy Tech Community College is a two-year vocational/technical college with locations surrounding the site in the cities of South Bend, Michigan City, and Valparaiso. Ivy Tech specializes in developing programs geared towards specific skills needed for existing manufacturers and other industries. A healthcare-

focused vocational education facilities, Ross Medical Education Center, is also located nearby in the City of South Bend.

Other higher education centers within an hour drive of the subject site include Purdue University's Northwest-Hammond Campus, Indiana Wesleyan University – Merrillville, Indiana University – South Bend, and Marian University's Ancilla College.

The site is within reach of several colleges and trade schools in the Chicago area, which is within an approximate 90-minute drive time, including the University of Illinois at Chicago, DeVry University Illinois, DePaul University, University of Chicago, Northwestern University, Loyola University Chicago, and Illinois Institute of Technology.

Business Climate is highly favorable for bringing in quality job-creating businesses to the area. Indiana is considered one of the best states in the nation for long-term fiscal stability and low corporate income tax rates, creating a business-forward environment throughout the state. The State of Indiana's target Industries according to the IEDC include advanced manufacturing, aerospace and aviation, ag-bioscience, defense, life sciences, logistics and transportation, and technology. These industries can take advantage of existing transportation assets throughout the state and county to serve an array of unique business logistical needs. The following target industries are listed by LaPorte County officials: electric vehicle components and manufacturers and other heavy industry.

LaPorte County has a labor force of 50,768 and an unemployment rate of 3.5%. Business development and assistance is provided locally by LaPorte County Government via the La Porte Economic Advancement Partnership (LEAP) and the LaPorte County Office of Economic Development.

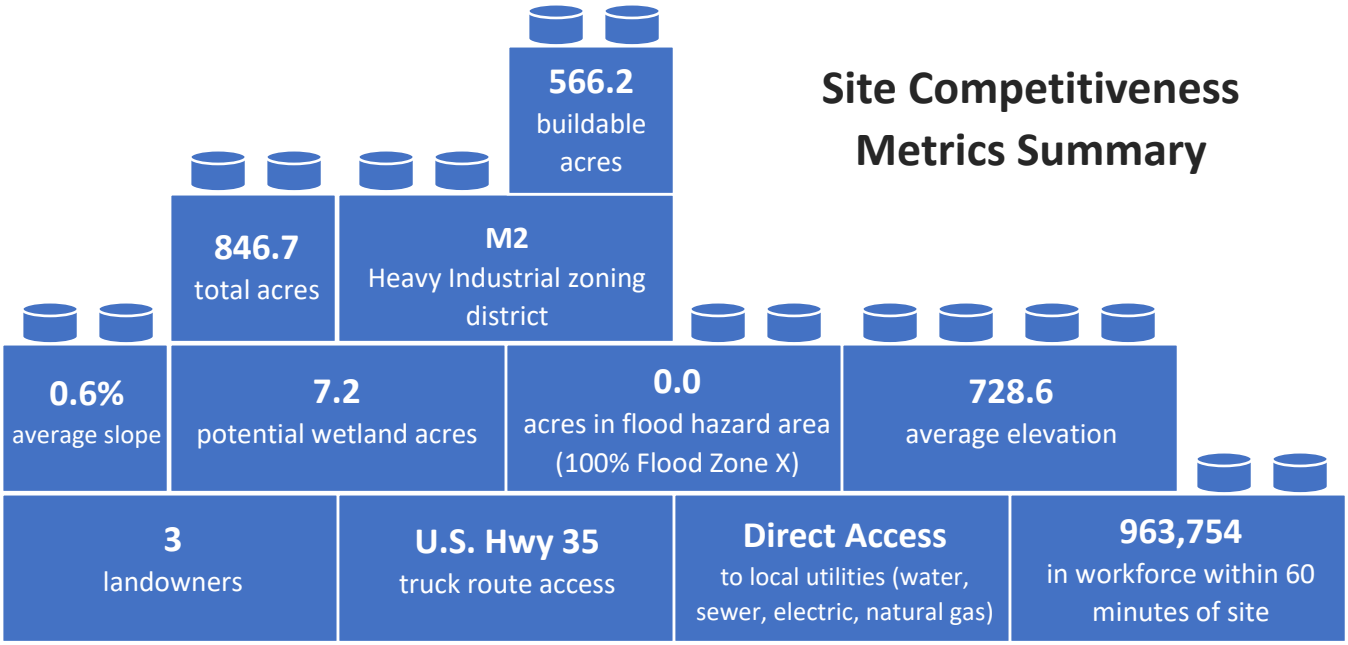
Local incentives include project financing support, access to trade zones, land acquisition and site preparation assistance, fast-track permitting process, utilities, and workforce development training. Both personal and real property abatements are available through LaPorte County and its cities. Tax abatement and Enterprise Zone incentives take approximately 60 days to implement. Tax Increment Financing (TIF), a method of facilitating development or redevelopment for a business by utilizing future tax revenues to pay for necessary improvements, is available and generally takes approximately six months to one year. *The site is located within the Laporte County TIF district.*

In addition, the IEDC provides for a variety of programs and initiatives offering business support and expertise to companies that are investing and creating jobs in Indiana. These include the Indiana Regional Cities Initiative, Certified Technology Park program, Broadband Ready Communities program, and Next Level Roads program.

The State of Indiana offers a variety of incentives for all types of businesses, including targeted industries, workforce training, infrastructure and special opportunity incentives. Indiana's business tax structure is competitive—the corporate income tax is decreasing to 4.9%, and the state offers many business tax incentives, corporate tax credits and economic development programs. Statewide incentives include the Community Revitalization Enhancement District (CRED) Tax Credit, Data Center Gross Retail and Use Tax Exemption, Economic Development for a Growing Economy (EDGE) Tax Credit, Industrial Grant Fund (IDGF), Tax Exemption for Patent-derived Income, Skills Enhancement Fund (SEF), Venture Capital

Investment Tax Credit program, Hoosier Business Investment (HBI) Tax Credit, Research Expense Credits, Research and Development Sales Tax Exemption, and Redevelopment Tax Credit (RTC).

Political Climate is strong according to interviews with local officials, and the community is largely in favor of commercial/industrial business development to bring long-term economic growth to the area, especially in advanced manufacturing sectors.



Site Competitiveness Report Card

The Site Competitiveness Report Card is an indicator of favorable development conditions across customary competitiveness factors. A relative score for each factor is given as a letter grade, akin to a 4.0 education grade point average (GPA). The GPA is calculated for each competitiveness area: Condition, Connection, and Community with an overall site GPA derived as a relative indicator of site competitiveness for an economic development land use.

Competitiveness Driver		
Condition	Comments	3.1
Engineering		
	Elevation/Slope	A
	Flood Risk	A
	Buildable Configuration	C
	Land Cover	A
Environmental/Cultural Resource		
	Potential Wetlands	A
	Legacy Environmental Liabilities	D
	Potential T&E Risk	A
Connectivity		3.2
Transportation		
	Interstate	C
	Multi-lane Truck Route	B
	Class I Rail	A
	Airport (passenger)	B
	Airport (cargo)	B
	Seaport/Inland Port	B
Utilities		
	Potable Water	B
	Sewer/Wastewater Treatment	B
	Natural Gas	A
	Electric	A
	Broadband/Fiber	A
Community		3.6
Cultural		
	Compatibility with Surrounding Land Use	A
	Community Acceptance	A
Economic		
	Market Vitality	A
	Tax Incentives	A
Labor		
	Workforce	A
	Wage Competitiveness	A
Political		
	Permitting Expediency	D
	Business Climate	A

Site GPA

3.3

Rough Order-of-Magnitude Site Development Cost Summary

A rough order-of-magnitude (ROM) cost estimation for pre-construction site preparation and utility and transportation infrastructure improvements was calculated to provide a general understanding of potential site development costs. ROM costs were calculated for the 184.3-acre buildable area, which was devised to avoid more costly site leveling due to elevation/slope conditions occurring on the eastern-southeastern perimeter of the site. ROM cost tables for the buildable area are presented below.

Notes:

- *Does not include costs for engineering, permitting, or general project management.*
- *This cost estimate was prepared with the best information available at the time of analysis.*
- *Actual costs can vary based on availability of material, site conditions, and labor.*
- *ROM costs generated from GIS data and use of RSMeans construction cost estimating software.*

ROM Costs for 18091-701 Buildable Area (566.2 acres)

Project: 18157-001
Location: Tippacanoe, IN

WORK ACTIVITY	QUANTITY	UNIT	UNIT COST	SUBTOTAL	TOTAL
ON-SITE PREPARATION					
Site Clearing					
Mobilization	1.00	EA	$40,000.00	$40,000.00	
Demolition (Structure)	1.00	EA	$25,000.00	$25,000.00	
Clearing	5.00	AC	$2,500.00	$12,500.00	
Topsoil Strip/Cut	250066.67	CY	[illegible]	$577,654.00	
Total Site Clearing				$655,154.00	$655,154.00
Grading Cut					
Earth Cut	859393.00	[illegible]	$3.50	$3,007,875.50	
Total Grading Cut				$3,007,875.50	$3,007,875.50
Grading Fill					
Earth Fill	859393.00	CY	$3.50	$3,007,875.50	
Total Grading Fill				$3,007,875.50	$3,007,875.50
Other Preparation					
Fine Grading (Building)	[illegible].00	SY	$1.45	$0.00	
Fine Grading (Non-Building)	[illegible].00	SY	$0.95	$0.00	
Erosion Control	100.00	AC	$2,500.00	$250,000.00	
Seeding	300.00	AC	$1,250.00	$375,000.00	
Total Other Preparation				$625,000.00	$625,000.00
			TOTAL		**$7,295,905.00**
OFF-SITE IMPROVEMENTS					
Road Improvements					
Turning Lane Left (300')	1.00	EA	$196,086.42	$196,086.42	
Turning Lane Right (300')	1.00	EA	$189,320.60	$189,320.60	
Total Road Improvements				$385,407.02	$385,407.02
			TOTAL		**$385,407.02**

DRAFT

Project: 18157-001
Location: Tippacanoe, IN

WORK ACTIVITY	QUANTITY	UNIT	UNIT COST	SUBTOTAL	TOTAL
ON-SITE IMPROVEMENTS					
Paving - Asphalt					
Asphalt Paving - Drives (Light Duty)	0.00	SY	$19.06	$0.00	
Asphalt Paving - Drives (Heavy Duty)	83700.00	SY	$25.32	$2,119,551.84	
Total Paving - Asphalt				$2,119,551.84	$2,119,551.84
				TOTAL	**$2,119,551.84**
UTILITIES & DRAINAGE					
Water	4600.00	LF	$65.00	$299,000.00	
Sewer	3100.00	LF	$75.00	$232,500.00	
Subsurface Drainage	3100.00	LF	$132	$409,200.00	
Drainage Outfall	1.00	EA	$100,000.00	$100,000.00	
3 Phase Electrical	3100.00	LF	$189.00	$585,900.00	
Total Utilities				$1,626,600.00	$1,626,600.00
				TOTAL	**$1,626,600.00**
RAIL					
Spur	3000.00	LF	$500.00	$1,500,000.00	
Crossing	1.00	EA	$80,000.00	$80,000.00	
Switch	2.00	EA	$500,000.00	$1,000,000.00	
Total Rail Improvements				$2,580,000.00	$2,580,000.00
				TOTAL	**$2,580,000.00**
WETLAND MITIGATION(optional)					
Compensatory Mitigation (unverified)	0.00	AC	$109,200.00	$0.00	
Total Mitigation (not indluding contingency or costs)				$0.00	$0.00
				TOTAL	**$0.00**
				SUB-TOTAL	**$14,007,463.86**
			Construction Contingency	10%	$1,400,746.39
			Total Cost Estimate For Site Construction w/o Mitigation		**$15,408,210.25**
			Total Cost Estimate For Site Construction with Mitigation		**$15,408,210.25**
SOFT COSTS					
Engineering				9.00%	$1,386,738.92
Surveying & Staking				2.50%	$385,205.26
Testing & Inspecting				1.00%	$154,082.10
Construction Management				4.75%	$731,889.99
Studies					$100,000.00
				TOTAL	**$2,757,916.27**
				Total Cost Estimate For Site	**$18,166,126.51**

DRAFT

Site Competitiveness Opinion

The Kingsbury Industrial Park in LaPorte County is a large site with over 550 buildable acres and adequate infrastructure/community support in place to support a heavy industrial project.

The site has several competitive features that position it as a strategic real estate asset to support economic development. Firstly, the site has access to all major utilities including electricity, natural gas, wastewater & sewer, potable water, and broadband/fiber. The site also offers multiple contiguous 200+ acre PADs that are mostly flat and dry with favorable soils for large-scale industrial development. There is a skilled workforce in the area and a workforce population of nearly 950,000 within a 60-minute drivetime. Proximity to several regional and international airports with freight and commercial services is another positive attribute. The site is in an ideal position for truck access with several different routes available to reach the nearby metropolitan areas of Indianapolis and Chicago including I-80/90, I-94, and I-65. There should not be any uncertainty regarding property availability, as LaPorte County economic development officials have confirmed that the landowners are actively promoting the site for sale. With industrial zoning in place and LaPorte County community and political leadership working together as strong proponents of business growth and new job creation, quick permitting expediency should also be expected. Finally, there are nearby hospitals, law enforcement, fire protection, and EMS to provide services to future on-site facilities.

Some challenges for the site also exist, including potential environmental legacy issues and the need to perform a Phase I Environmental Site Assessment (ESA). The site is adjacent to the Fisher-Calo Chemical Superfund site. Four groundwater contamination plumes exist within the superfund boundaries, just west and north of the Kingsbury Industrial Park. There is a real risk that the groundwater contamination has migrated onto the subject site. A more extensive environmental site investigation on the subject site by a qualified consultant is needed to better understand potential onsite contamination and needed remediation. Currently when leaving the site, truck traffic must travel a minimum of 11.0 miles to access the interstate. While all roadways leading to interstate access appear to be in good condition and suitable for truck traffic, the 11.0-mile distance is considered a challenge. It is recommended that a focus be placed on attracting industries that have a tolerance for being without direct interstate access. Having close access to a four-lane U.S. Highway and multiple different routes to large metropolitan areas should be sufficient in attracting a variety of desired industry types. Another potential challenge for the site is buildable configuration. The site is divided into thirds by roads and existing businesses, thus limiting the full potential of the buildable area and certain footprints needed. One additional challenge is that the existing capacity for sewer/wastewater (2 MGD) and potable water (1.5 MGD) could limit the site to certain industry types.

Upon considering the factors mentioned throughout the SSI Phase II Report, it is the opinion of LL+D that the Kingsbury Industrial Park should be considered a nationally competitive site for attracting quality job-producing heavy industrial and light industrial manufacturing projects to LaPorte County. With direct access to all major utilities and a four-lane U.S. Highway, a large, flat, and dry buildable area, adequate workforce availability, and landowner willingness and zoning in line with industrial development, the property should be considered a high-quality site that is prime for development.

Subject Site Key Facts

Advantages	Disadvantages
A large buildable area of just over 560 acres is available and divided into three separate PADs (119.7 acres, 222.3 acres, and 224.2 acres).	The site is divided into thirds by roads and existing businesses, thus limiting the full potential of the buildable area.
The site has low flood risk, no recorded or observed hydrography features, and minimal wetlands across the entirety of the buildable area.	While all roadways leading to interstate access appear to be in good condition and suitable for truck traffic, the 11.0-mile distance from the site is considered a challenge for certain industry types.
LaPorte County community and political leadership are strong proponents of business growth and new job creation creating a business climate highly conductive to project investment.	As of the date of this report, no known real estate purchase option agreement is held with any person or organization with the landowners for any portion of the site. LL+D strongly recommends that LaPorte County pursue and secure a real estate purchase option agreement with the landowners. This is critically important to reduce uncertainty regarding property availability and price.
The surrounding land use is ideal to support the development of heavy industrial and light industrial park project land uses.	
The majority of the buildable area has soils that are very favorable for an industrial project land use. Good performance and very low maintenance can be expected.	The existing capacity for sewer/wastewater (2 MGD) and potable water (1.5 MGD) could limit the site to certain industry types.
The site is well connected to all utility infrastructure assets (electric, natural gas, wastewater, potable water, and telecom).	The site is adjacent to the Fisher-Carlo Chemical Superfund site. Four groundwater contamination plumes exist within the superfund boundaries, just west and north of the Kingsbury industrial Park. There is a real risk that the contamination has migrated onto the subject site. A more extensive environmental site investigation on the subject site by a qualified consultant is needed to better understand potential onsite contamination.
LaPorte County economic development officials have confirmed that the three landowners are actively promoting the site for sale.	
Access to surrounding labor markets at competitive wage rates is well within reach of the subject site.	
There is a workforce population of greater than 950,000 within a 60-minute drive time of the site.	

Purpose and Use of Study

Sites originating from Phase I have demonstrated qualitative compliance with engineering. environmental, infrastructure, and cultural location criteria. That said, in order to develop an actionable understanding of true site competitiveness, a more detailed study of the subject site is required. SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence is designed for this purpose.

Purpose

The purpose of the SSI Phase II study is to provide an understanding of the subject site's advantages and challenges in conjunction with a ROM cost estimate to improve site functional use and mitigate development challenges. The SSI Phase II study is a desktop-based preliminary due diligence exercise performed by discipline-specific experts with experience in industrial and commercial property development. Study of the subject site's physical and surrounding characteristics, assets, and impediments for development are reviewed in sufficient detail to formulate a defendable opinion on the competitive value of the property for economic development.

Use

There are three primary intended uses of an SSI Phase II report: (1) site advancement decision support; (2) consideration for investment in site improvements; and (3) site marketing. Each intended use is discussed below.

Site Advancement Decision

The SSI Phase II study is designed to provide decision support for the advancement of sites to market though the landowner engagement process. SSI Phase II findings serve as an indicator for the likelihood the subject site will survive the intensive scrutiny of formal, field-based engineering and environmental due diligence. Detection of severe site deficiencies or encumbrances, often referred to as fatal flaws, during desktop preliminary due diligence can avoid expenditure of significant resources in subjecting sites with little chance of survival to formal due diligence. Short of fatal flaws, SSI Phase II may reveal less than ideal conditions or less severe yet concerning challenges that can marginalize site competitiveness or be detrimental to business attraction, respectively. The most important use of the SSI Phase II study is to ensure confidence in the decision to advance sites to market graduation through subsequent phases for landowner engagement and formal due diligence. *Ultimately, site advancement decisions should be tempered by local industry targets and the host community's real estate needs to support those targets.*

Site Improvement Investment Considerations

The findings of the Phase II study, along with an estimate of the ROM costs needed to make functional site and infrastructure improvements, provides concrete data for Economic Development Offices (EDOs) to consider while making investment decisions to improve site marketability. There may be strong business cases for increasing site competitiveness by making incremental investment in infrastructure improvements or mitigation of development challenges. There are many conditions to be considered in investing significant dollars on speculative site improvements including market, economic, fiscal, real

estate, and political factors. While the information provided through the SSI Phase II study should not be exclusively considered for site improvement expenditures, the findings may provide an initial quasi prospectus on site development expenditure and associated return-on-investment (ROI).

Site Marketing

The best greenfield site in America is of no consequence to the host community if industry prospects are unaware of its value and availability. Many EDOs invest in branding and marketing campaigns to showcase their community's differentiating attributes to attract business investment. If prematurely launched, many communities unfortunately become "the dog that caught the car". The well-qualified community successfully attracts the serious interest of a prospective company only to lose the project, and possibly credibility for future projects, because it fails to offer a competitive site.

It is the opinion of LL+D, based on extensive industrial and commercial site selection experience, that the methodology, objectivity, and level of detail and completeness provided in this report are sufficient to support the competitive claims of the subject site for its intended project land use(s). Accordingly, the information contained in this report can and should be used to supplement site marketing materials, specifically for RFI responses and proactive target industry solicitations. However, EDOs should exercise judicious use of SSI Phase II site information for the purposes of site marketing in advance of formal landowner engagement and security of real estate purchase opinion. The real estate purchase option is pursued during SSI Phase III: Landowner Engagement.

Warranty

All Phase II project tasks are intended to serve as an informed guide to determination of site advancement to the formal due diligence phase of inventory development. All information and opinions provided in this report are limited to planning-level engineering and environmental considerations and do not rise to the investigative level of study for site design uses.

All data used in this study originates from public domain sources. All findings derived from the use of public domain data are subject to potential errors and omissions inherent digital data sets which may include spatial and attribute accuracy, completeness, and currency. Data and other information cited in this study has not been verified for quality of accuracy. As such, the confidence in findings provided herein and corresponding opinions are subject to the limitations of the data and other information sources consulted in the conduct of this study.

Ultimate site development potential and fatal flaw analysis cannot be determined without physically visiting the site and conducting formal engineering and environmental due diligence. However, Leotta Location and Design is confident that our site screening methodology is highly effective in eliminating low quality or practically undevelopable sites and presents candidate sites with a high likelihood of confirming results through more formal engineering and environmental due diligence.

APPENDIX A

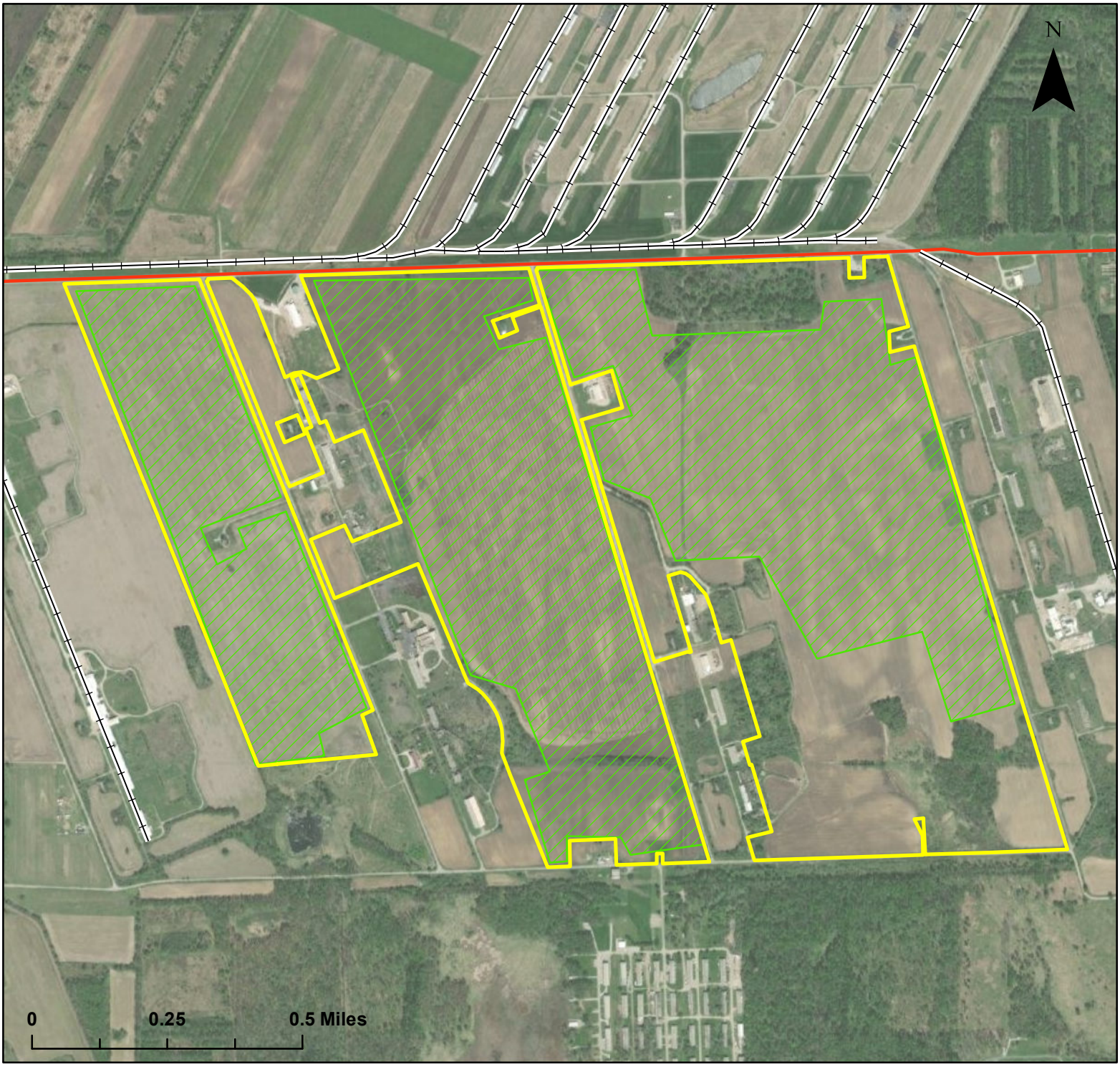
SITE MAPS

SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-701 (846.7 acres)

LaPorte County Indiana



Legend

- Rail
- E Hupp Rd
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area

SITE MAP

Site: ~846.7 acres

Buildable Area 1: ~119.7 acres

Buildable Area 2: ~222.3 acres

Buildable Area 3: ~224.2 acres

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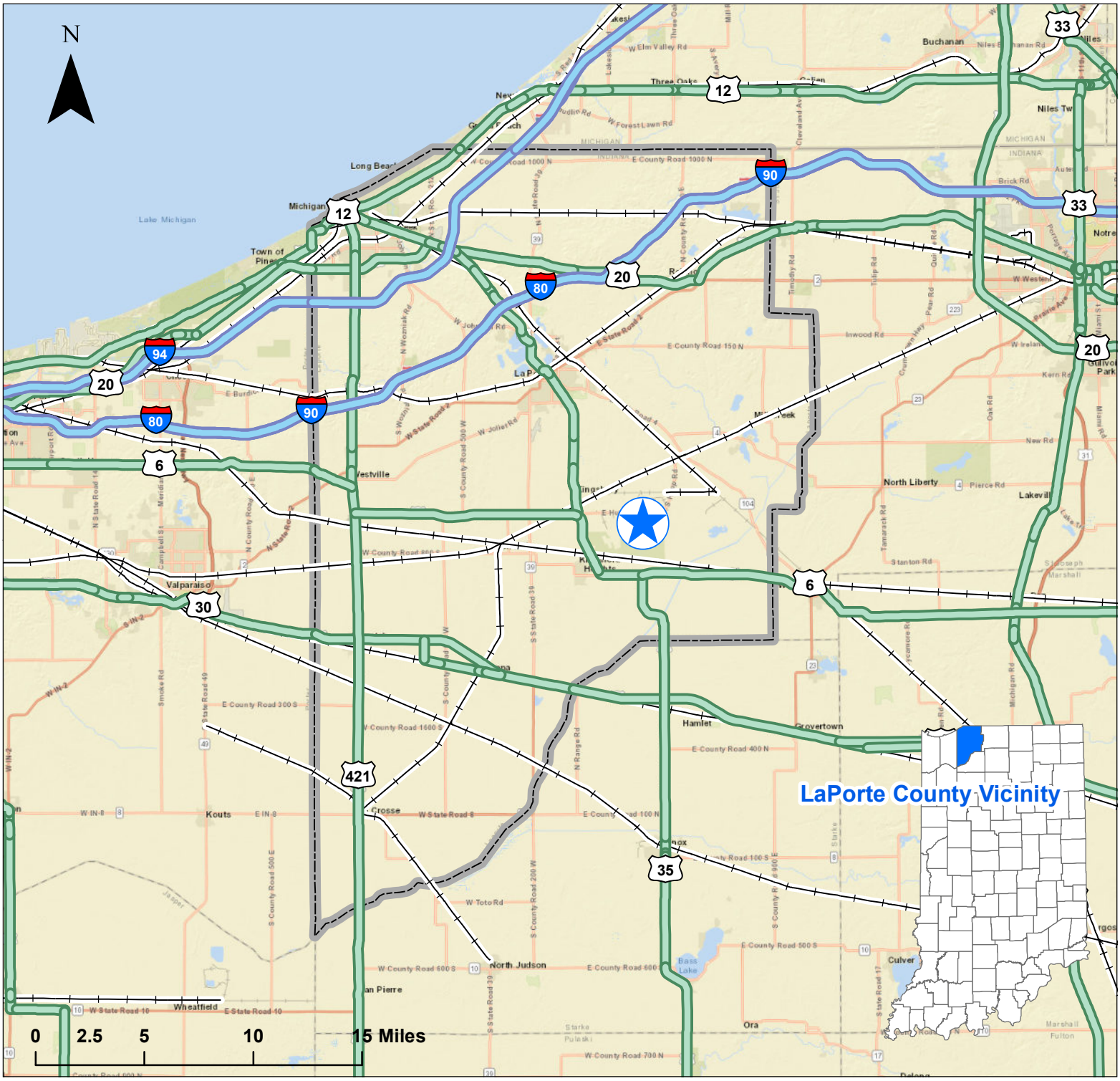
SSI Phase II conducted by: LEOTTA LOCATION + DESIGN

SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-701 (846.7 acres)

LaPorte County Indiana



Legend

- Site Point
- Interstate
- U.S. Highway
- Class I Railroad
- LaPorte County

SITE VICINITY

LaPorte County, Indiana

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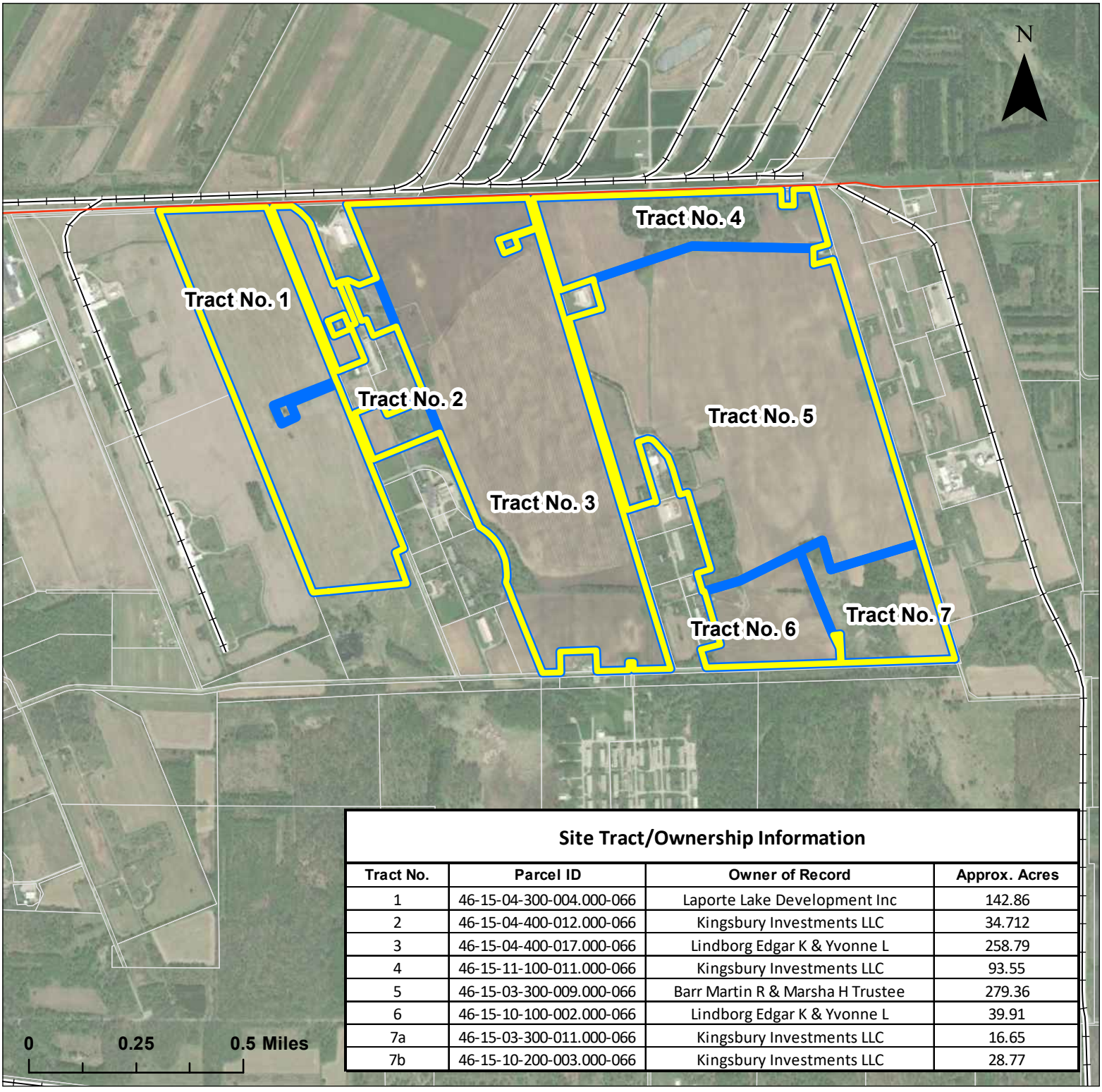
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-701 (846.7 acres)

LaPorte County Indiana



Site Tract/Ownership Information

Tract No.	Parcel ID	Owner of Record	Approx. Acres
1	46-15-04-300-004.000-066	Laporte Lake Development Inc	142.86
2	46-15-04-400-012.000-066	Kingsbury Investments LLC	34.712
3	46-15-04-400-017.000-066	Lindborg Edgar K & Yvonne L	258.79
4	46-15-11-100-011.000-066	Kingsbury Investments LLC	93.55
5	46-15-03-300-009.000-066	Barr Martin R & Marsha H Trustee	279.36
6	46-15-10-100-002.000-066	Lindborg Edgar K & Yvonne L	39.91
7a	46-15-03-300-011.000-066	Kingsbury Investments LLC	16.65
7b	46-15-10-200-003.000-066	Kingsbury Investments LLC	28.77

Legend

- E Hupp Rd
- Rail
- Site Boundary
- Site Parcel
- Parcel

SITE PARCEL CONFIGURATION

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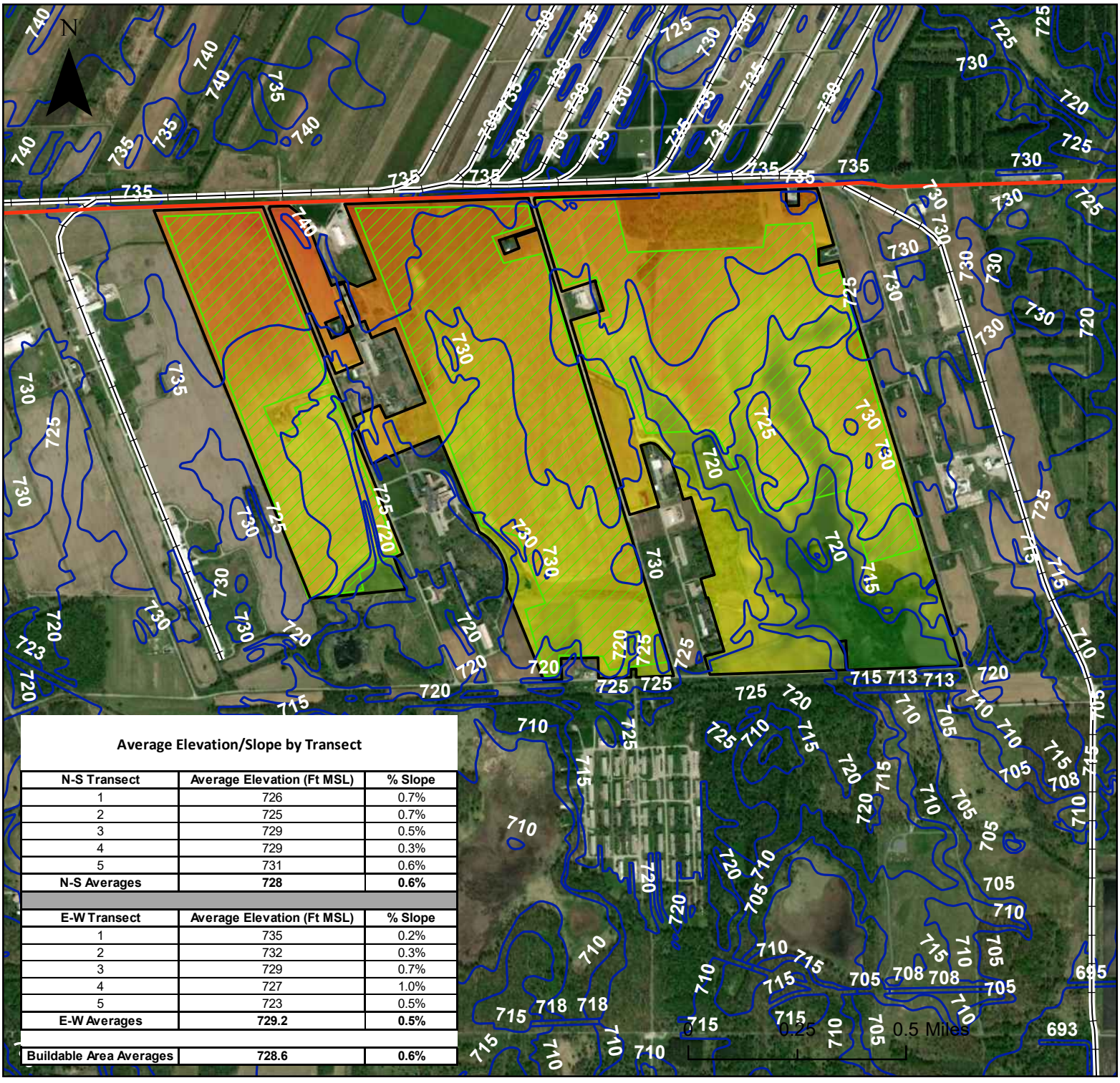
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-701 (846.7 acres)

LaPorte County Indiana



Average Elevation/Slope by Transect

N-S Transect	Average Elevation (Ft MSL)	% Slope
1	726	0.7%
2	725	0.7%
3	729	0.5%
4	729	0.3%
5	731	0.6%
N-S Averages	**728**	**0.6%**

E-W Transect	Average Elevation (Ft MSL)	% Slope
1	735	0.2%
2	732	0.3%
3	729	0.7%
4	727	1.0%
5	723	0.5%
E-W Averages	**729.2**	**0.5%**
Buildable Area Averages	**728.6**	**0.6%**

Legend

- E Hupp Rd
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area
- Contours - 10 ft

LiDAR-derived DEM

- High : 741'
- Low : 708'

BUILDABLE AREA ELEVATION/SLOPE

LiDAR-derived Digital Elevation Model

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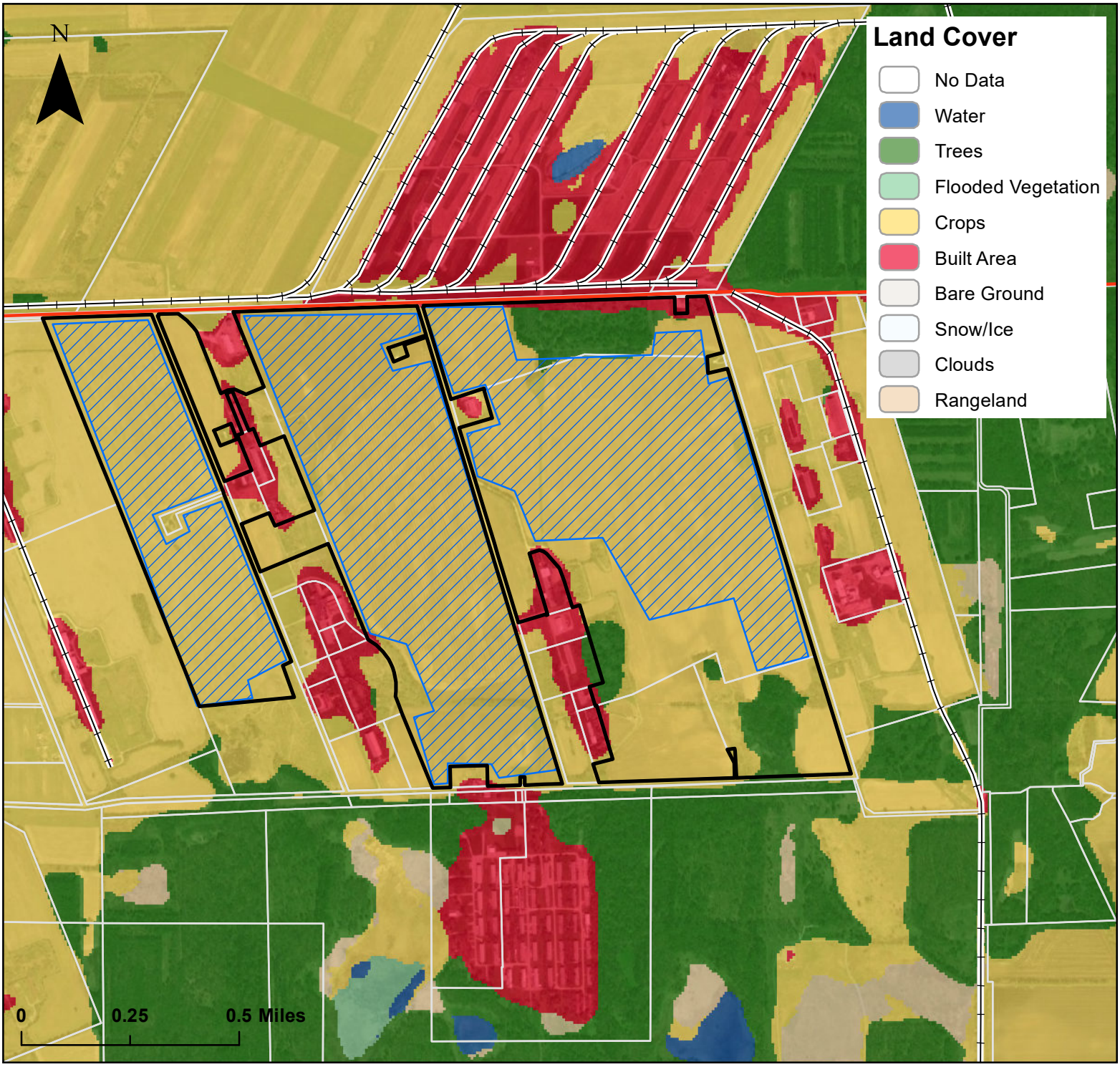
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-701 (846.7 acres)

LaPorte County Indiana



Legend

- Rail
- E_Hupp_Rd
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area
- Parcel

LAND COVER CLASSIFICATIONS

Indiana 2017-2021 Land Cover Map

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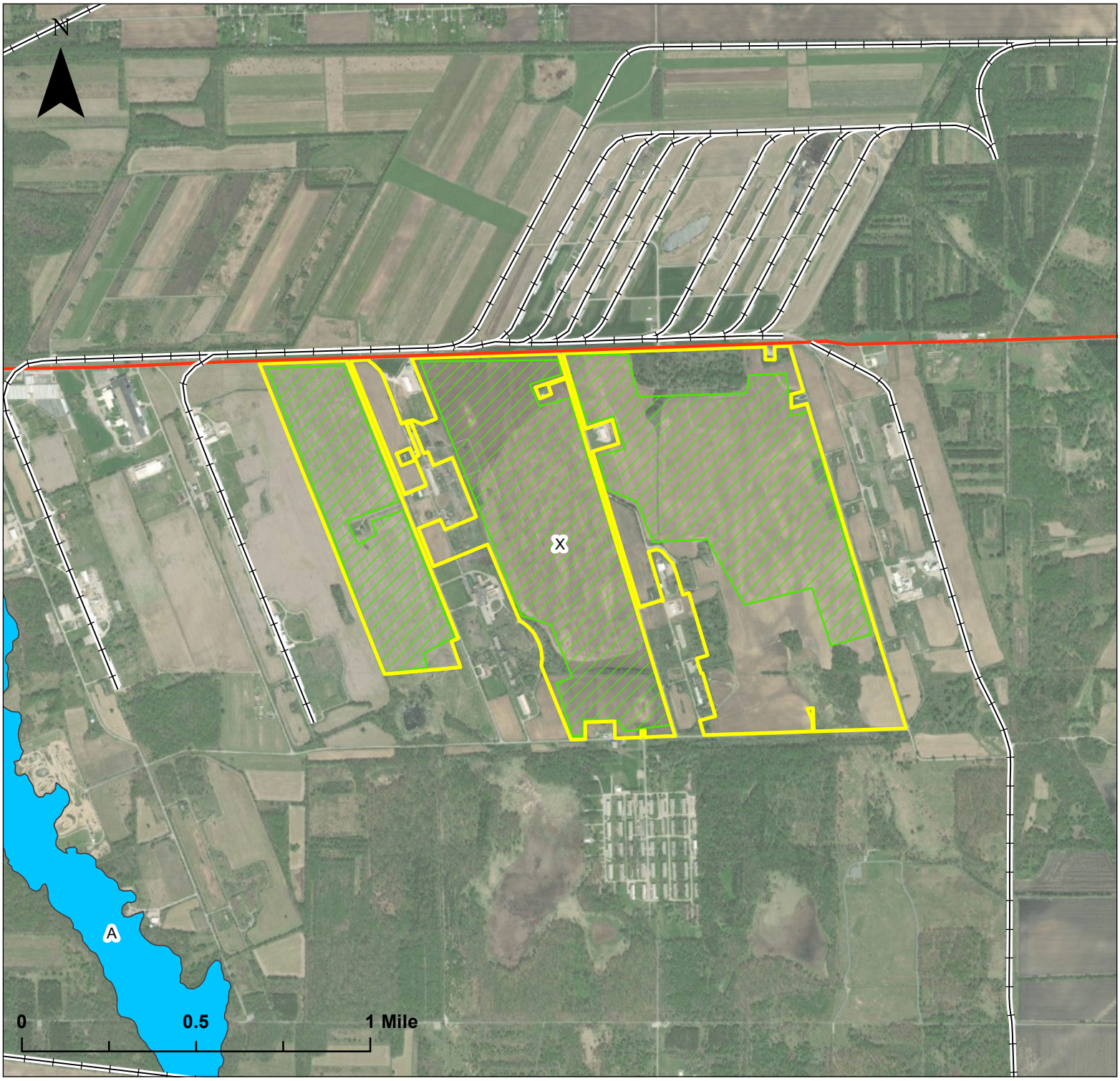
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-701 (846.7 acres)

LaPorte County Indiana



Legend

- Rail
- E Hupp Rd
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area

Flood Zone

- A
- X

Potential Flood Hazard

FEMA National Flood Hazard Layer

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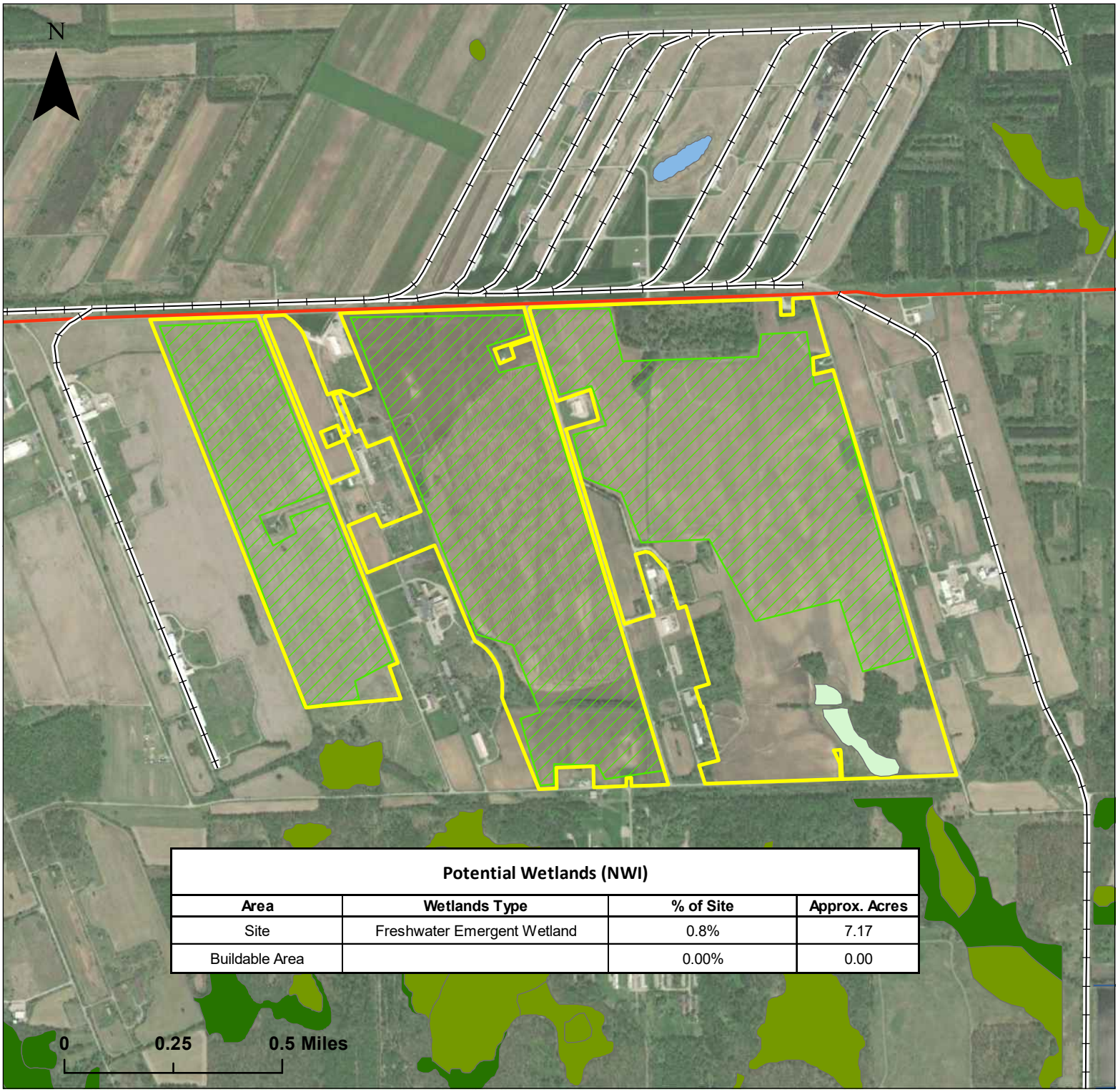
SSI Phase II conducted by: LEOTTA LOCATION + DESIGN

SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-701 (846.7 acres)

LaPorte County Indiana



Potential Wetlands (NWI)			
Area	**Wetlands Type**	**% of Site**	**Approx. Acres**
Site	Freshwater Emergent Wetland	0.8%	7.17
Buildable Area		0.00%	0.00

Legend

- Rail
- E Hupp Rd
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area

National Wetlands Inventory

Potential Wetland Type

- Freshwater Emergent Wetland
- Freshwater Forested/Shrub Wetland
- Freshwater Pond
- Riverine

Potential Wetlands

USFW/USGS National Wetlands Inventory

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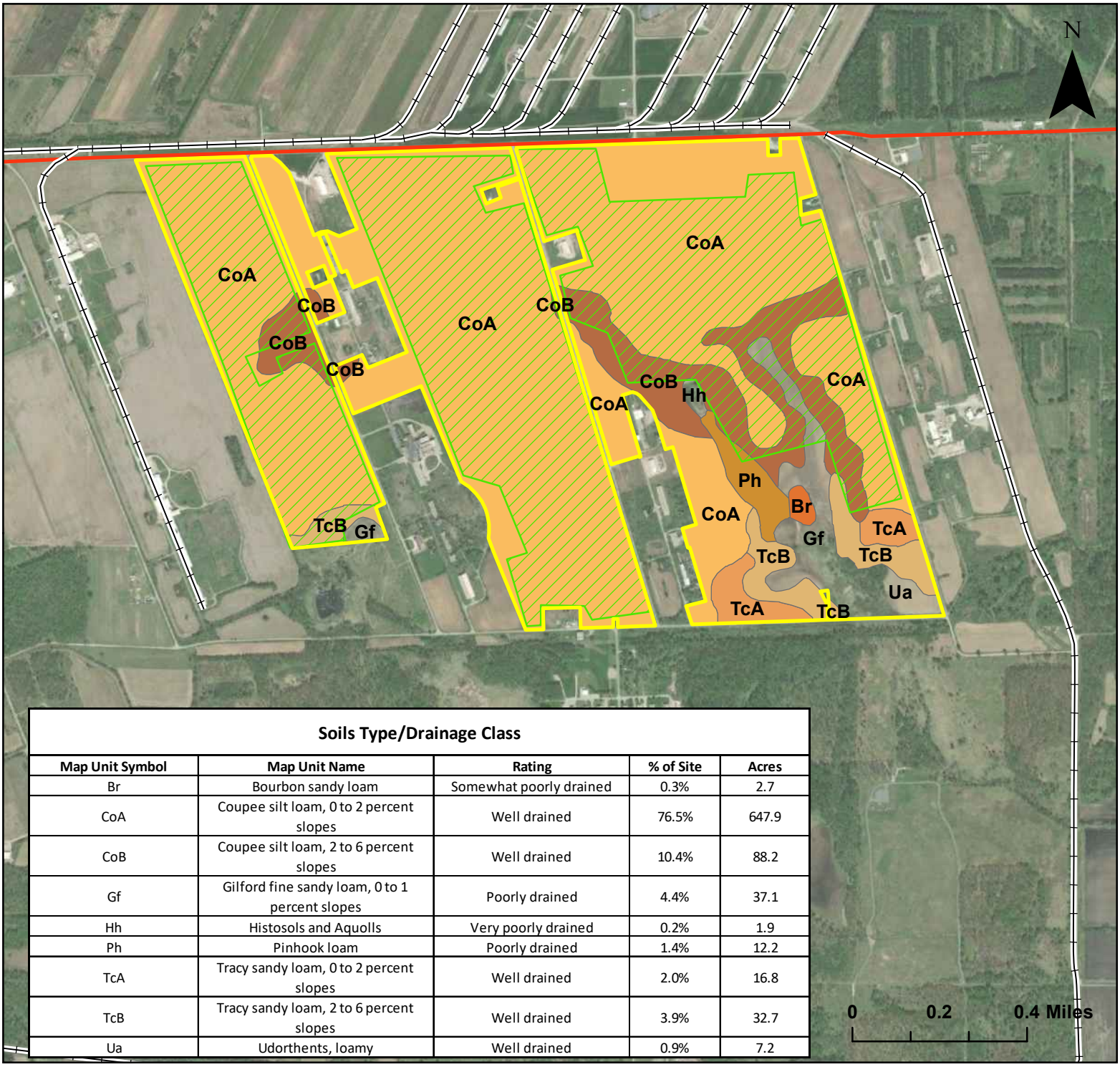
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-701 (846.7 acres)

LaPorte County Indiana



Soils Type/Drainage Class

Map Unit Symbol	Map Unit Name	Rating	% of Site	Acres
Br	Bourbon sandy loam	Somewhat poorly drained	0.3%	2.7
CoA	Coupee silt loam, 0 to 2 percent slopes	Well drained	76.5%	647.9
CoB	Coupee silt loam, 2 to 6 percent slopes	Well drained	10.4%	88.2
Gf	Gilford fine sandy loam, 0 to 1 percent slopes	Poorly drained	4.4%	37.1
Hh	Histosols and Aquolls	Very poorly drained	0.2%	1.9
Ph	Pinhook loam	Poorly drained	1.4%	12.2
TcA	Tracy sandy loam, 0 to 2 percent slopes	Well drained	2.0%	16.8
TcB	Tracy sandy loam, 2 to 6 percent slopes	Well drained	3.9%	32.7
Ua	Udorthents, loamy	Well drained	0.9%	7.2

Legend

- Rail
- E Hupp Rd
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area

Soil Type

- Ad
- Br
- CoA
- CoB
- Ed
- Pa
- Ph
- Sb
- TcA
- TcB
- TcC2
- Tr
- Wh

SSURGO SOILS

Map Unit Name, Percent Slopes

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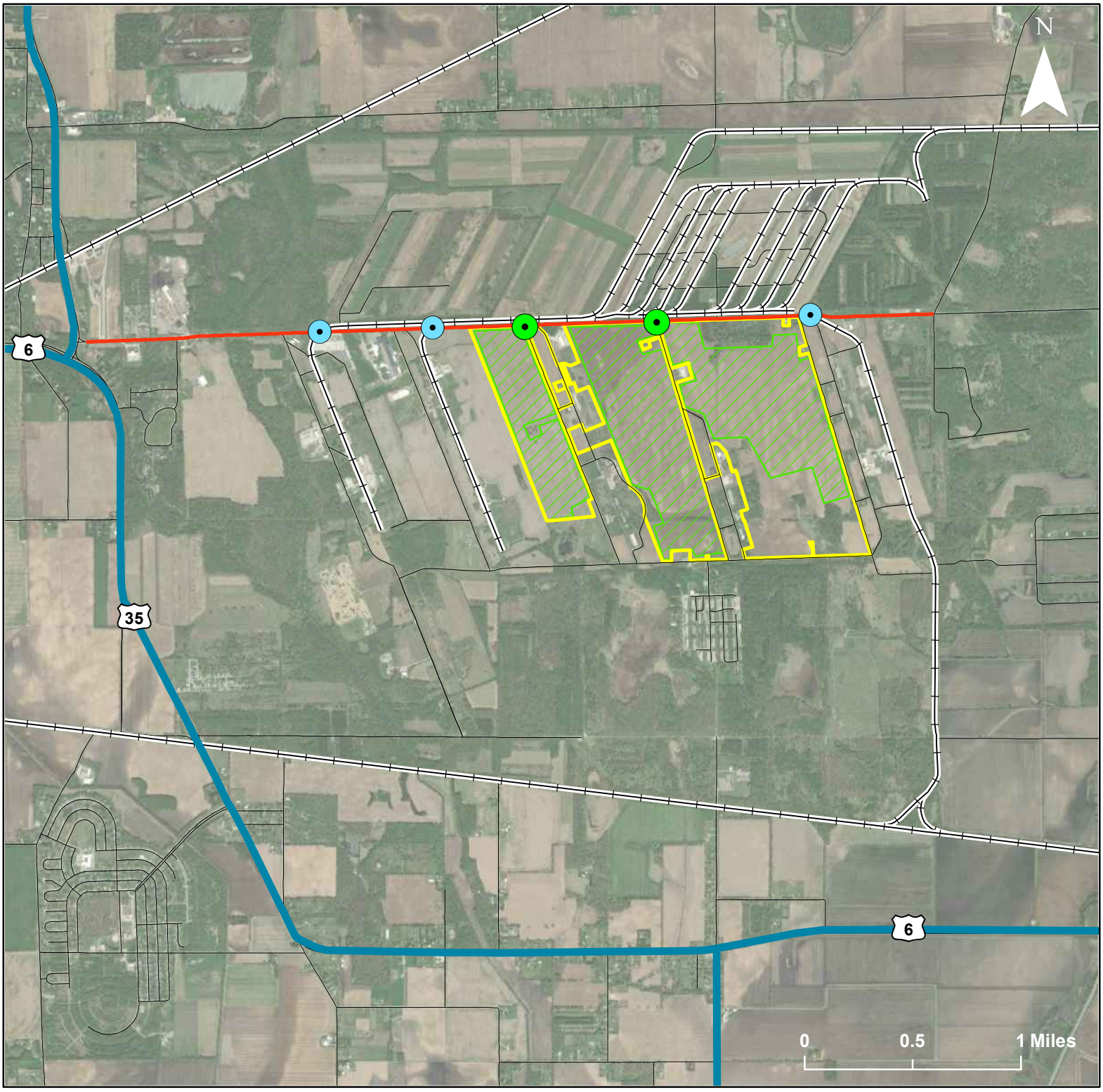
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-701 (846.7 acres)

LaPorte County Indiana



SITE TRANSPORTATION FEATURES

with Potential Site Access Points

Legend

- Potential Egress/Ingress Point
- Potential Rail Crossing
- U.S. Highway
- E Hupp Rd
- Street
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area

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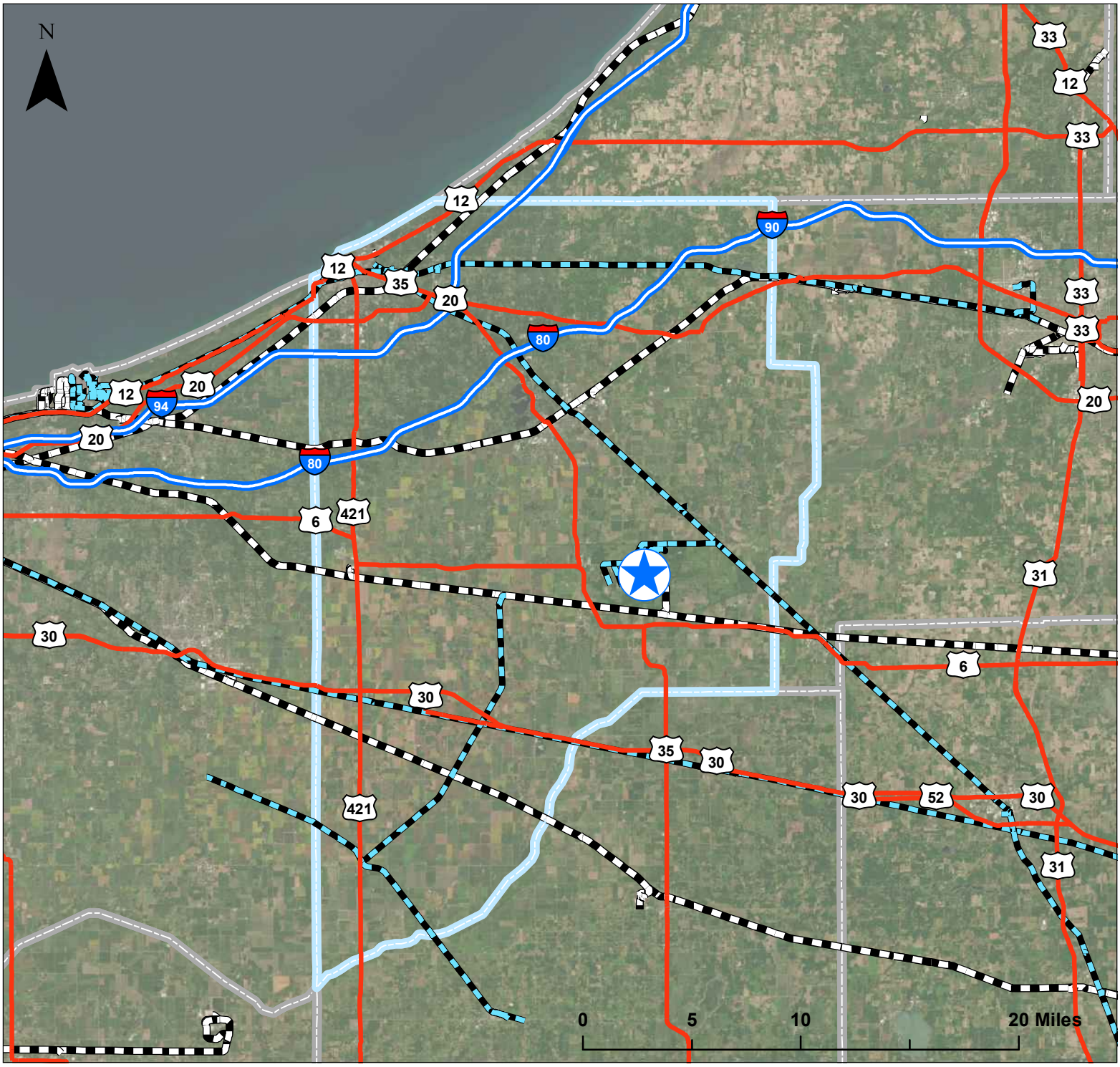
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-701 (846.7 acres)

LaPorte County Indiana



Legend

- Class I Railroad
- Shortline
- Interstate
- U.S. Highway

SITE PRIMARY TRANSPORTATION ASSETS

- Site Point
- LaPorte County
- County

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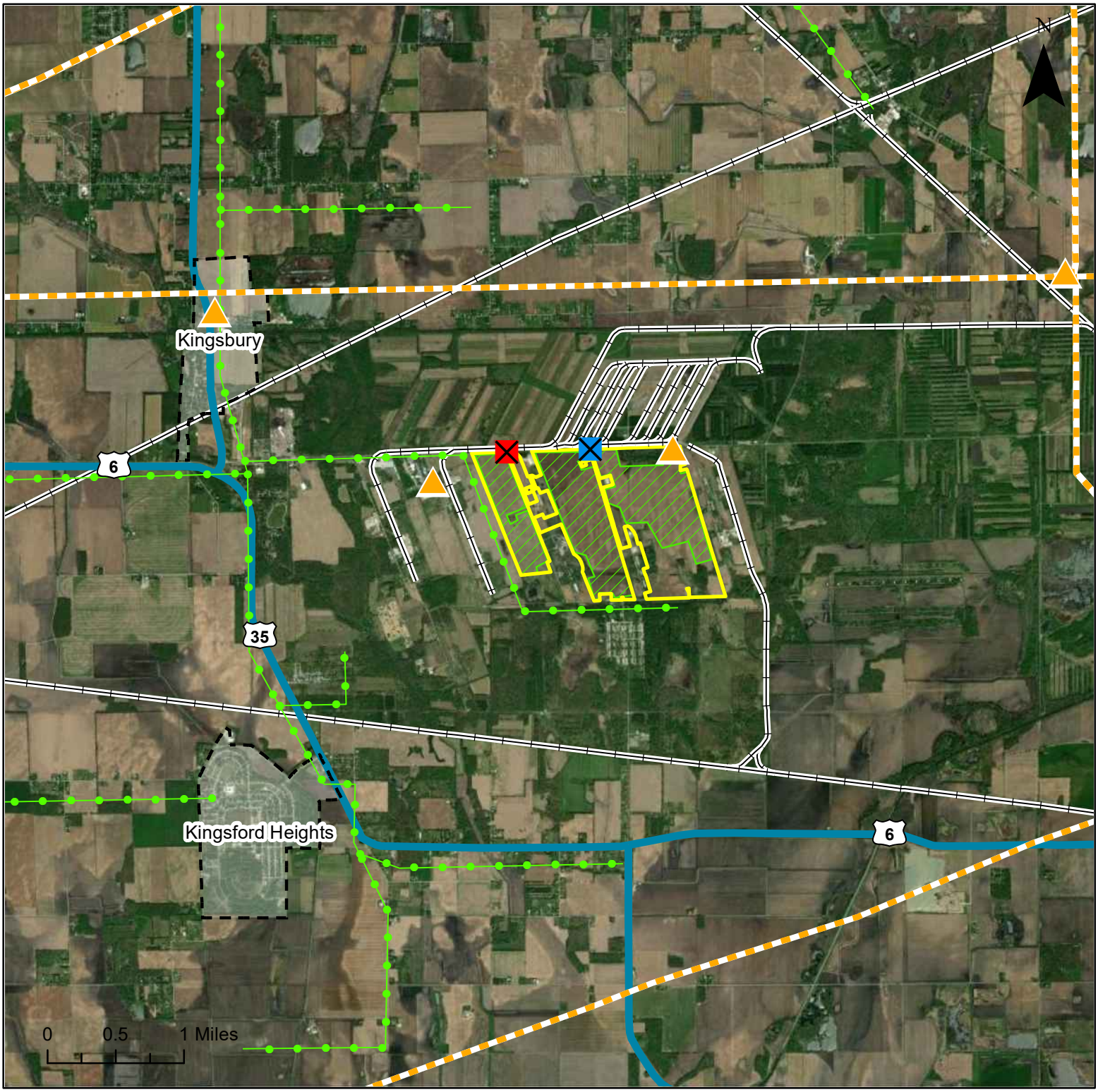
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-701 (846.7 acres)

LaPorte County Indiana



Legend

Utility Type

- Electric, Gas
- Water, Sewer
- Electric Substation
- Electric Transmission Line
- Natural Gas Pipeline
- U.S. Highway
- Rail
- Site Boundary
- Buildable Area
- Municipal Limits

ENERGY INFRASTRUCTURE/UTILITY ACCESS

with Utility Access Point

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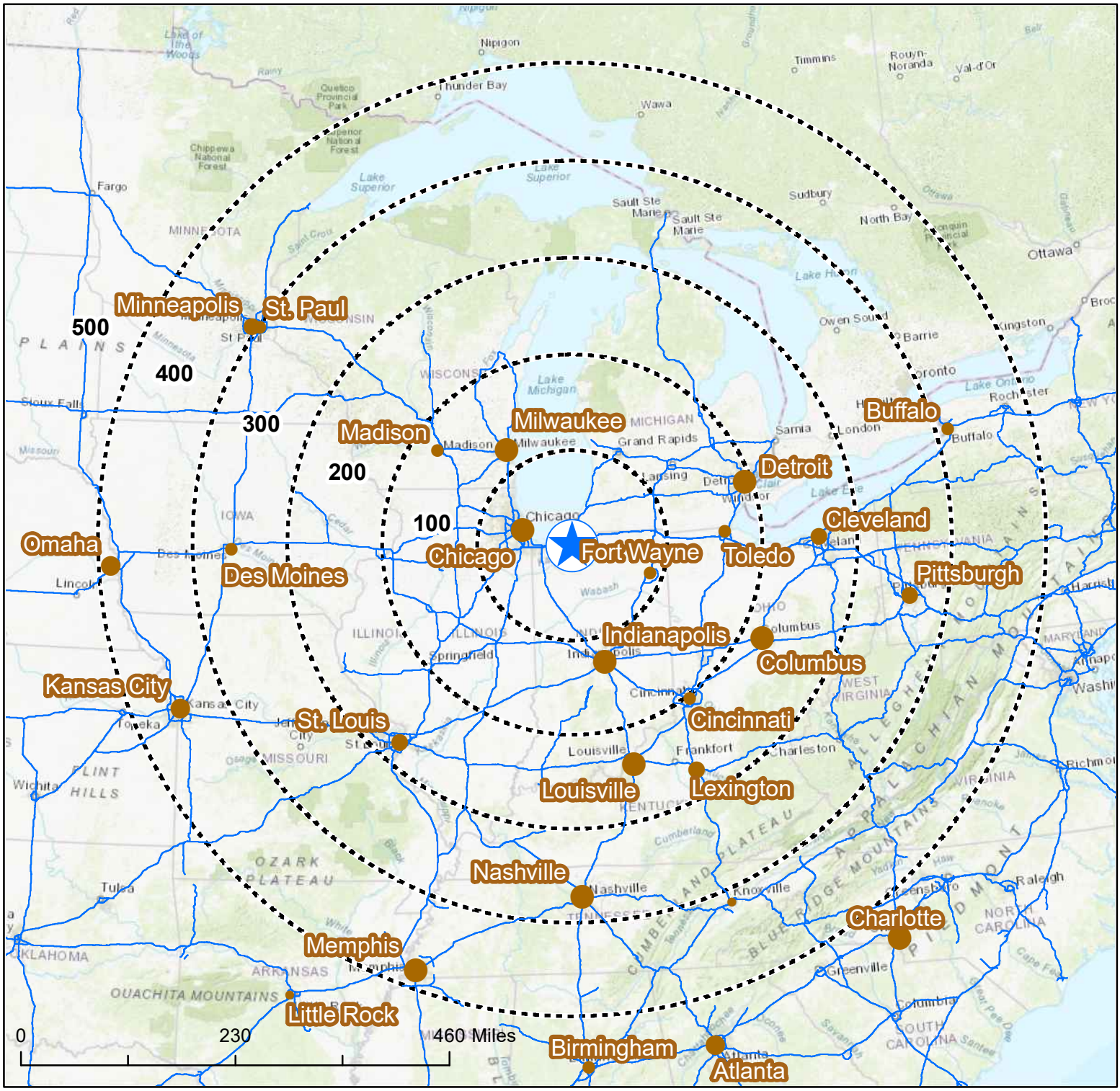
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-701 (846.7 acres)

LaPorte County Indiana



Legend

- Site Point
- Interstate
- Distance in Miles

Major Markets

Population

- <100,000
- 100,000 - 199,999
- 200,000 - 299,999
- 300,000 - 399,999
- 400,000 - 499,999
- >500,000

TRAVEL DISTANCE

Major Markets

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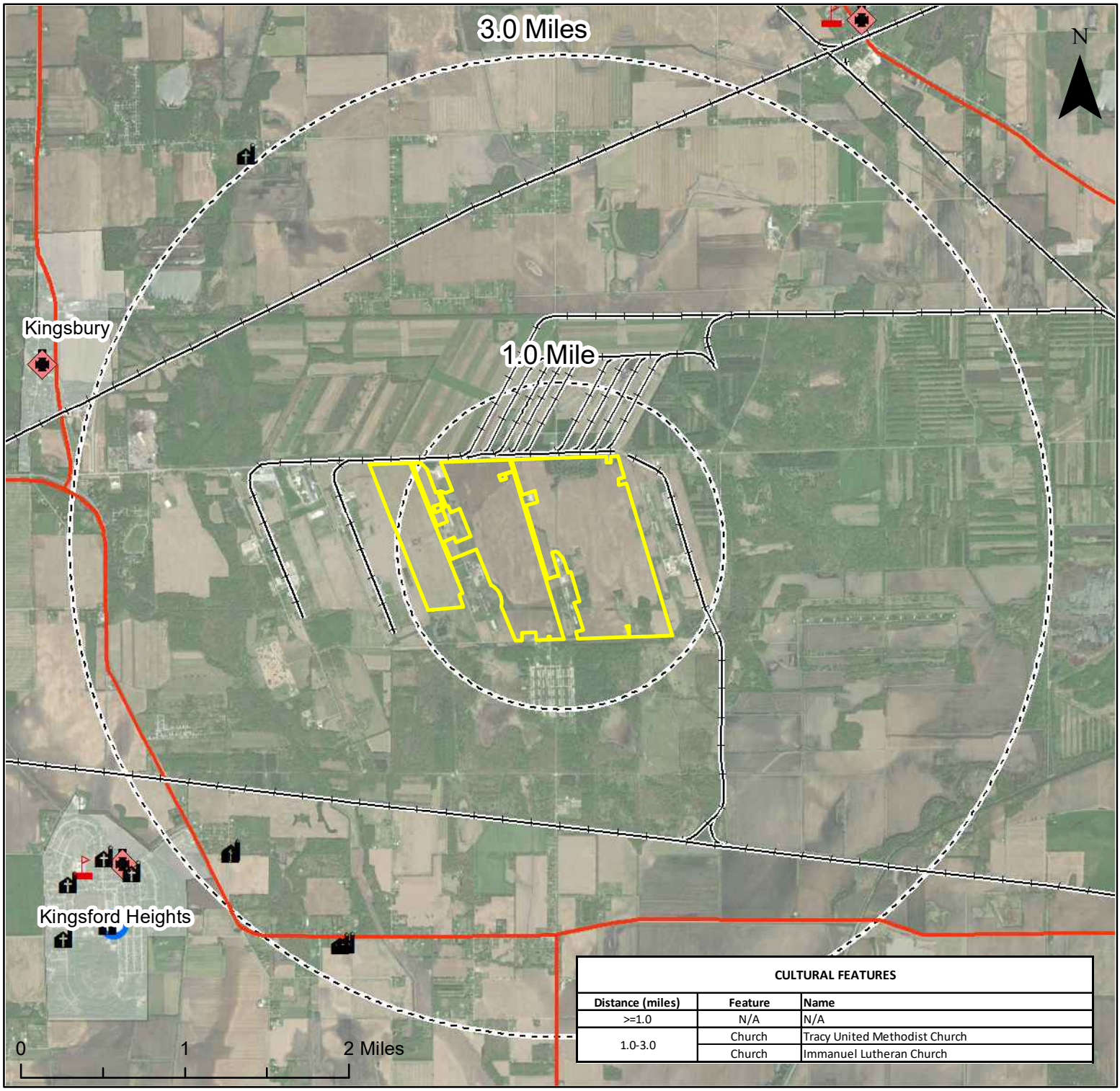
SSI Phase II conducted by: LEOTTA LOCATION + DESIGN

SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-701 (846.7 acres)

LaPorte County Indiana



CULTURAL FEATURES		
Distance (miles)	**Feature**	**Name**
>=1.0	N/A	N/A
1.0-3.0	Church	Tracy United Methodist Church
	Church	Immanuel Lutheran Church

Legend

- Rail
- Highway
- Site Boundary
- Distance in miles
- Municipal Limits
- Police Station
- Fire Rescue/EMS
- Hospital
- School
- Cemetery
- Church

CULTURAL FEATURES

within 1.0 and 3.0 Miles of Site

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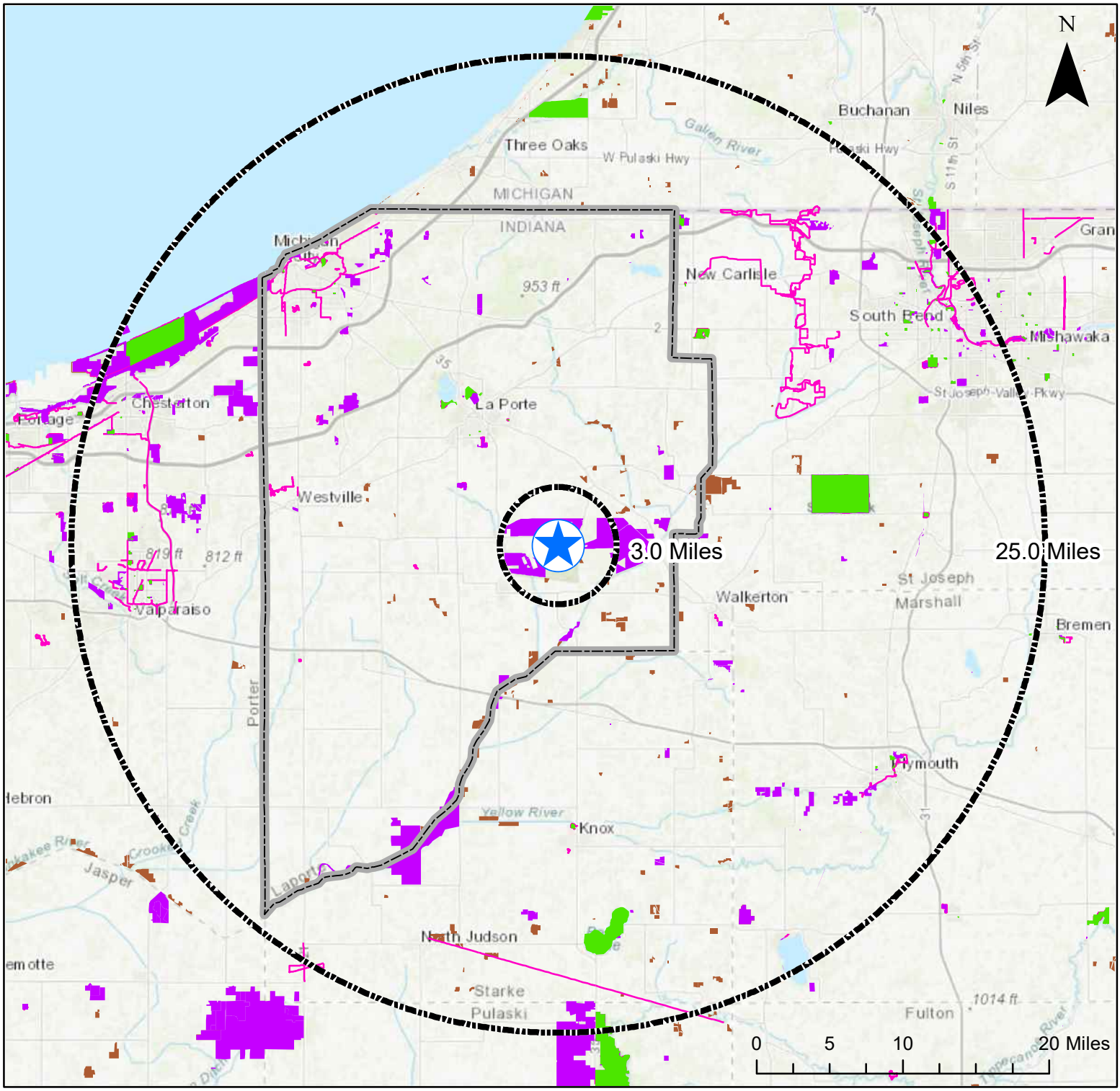
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SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-701 (846.7 acres)

LaPorte County Indiana



Legend

- Site Point
- IDNR Trails
- LaPorte County
- Local/State Parks
- National Forests
- INDR Managed Lands
- Conservation Easements
- Distance in Miles

FEDERAL, STATE, AND LOCAL PARKS AND PROTECTED AREAS

within 3.0 and 25.0 Miles of Site

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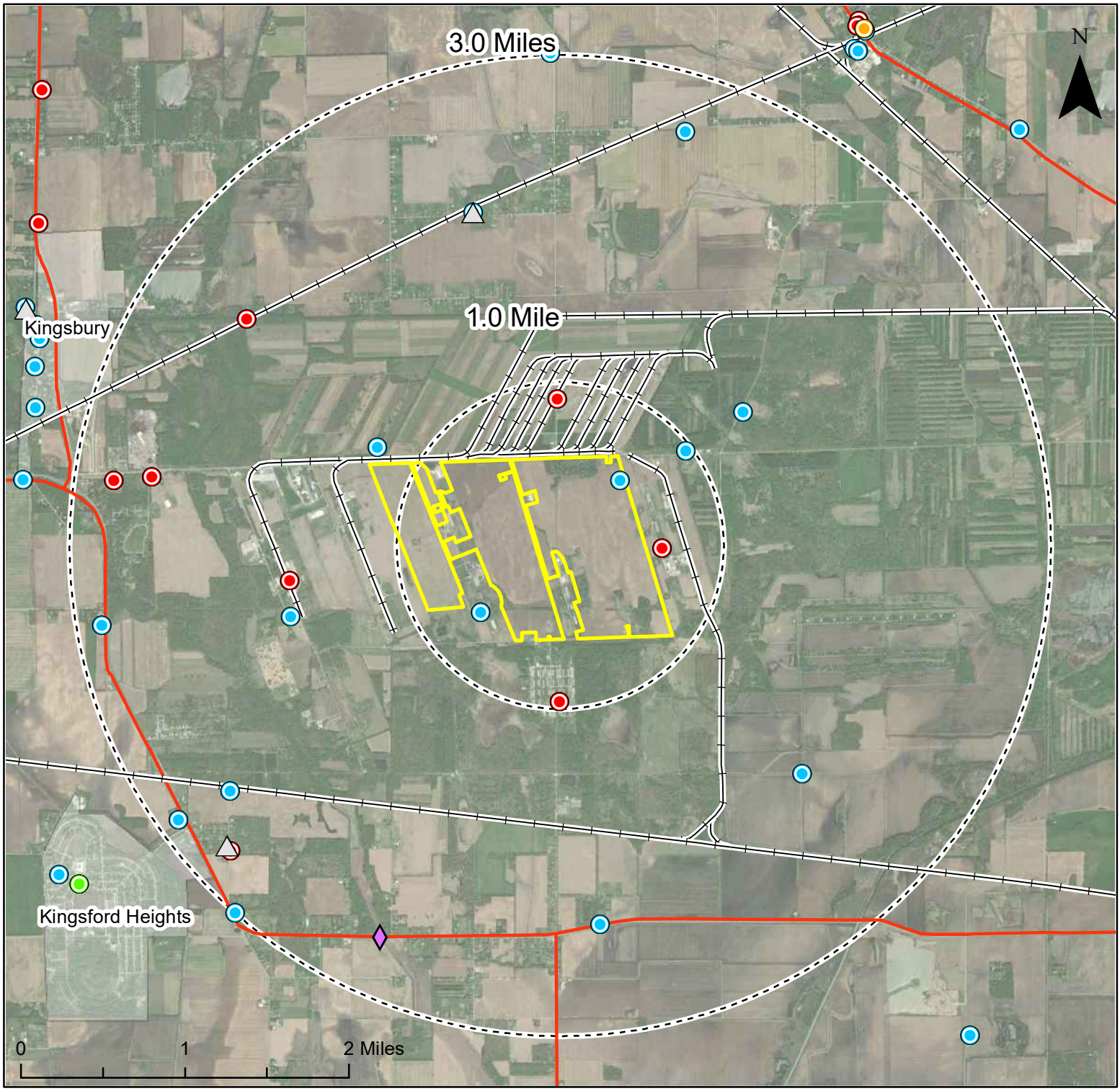
SSI Phase II conducted by: LEOTTA LOCATION + DESIGN

SSI Phase II: Preliminary Due Diligence

LaPorte County, Indiana

Site ID: 18091-701 (846.7 acres)

LaPorte County Indiana



Historic Sites and Structures

- Demolished
- Non-Contributing
- Contributing
- Notable
- Outstanding

- Historic Bridge
- Cemetery
- Rail
- Highway
- Site Boundary
- Distance in miles

HISTORIC RESOURCES

within 1.0 and 3.0 Miles of Site

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